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BARAPULLAH P-III TRAFFIC WOES TRIGGER FLOW REVIEW P3



BJP QUESTIONS IF CONGRESS WANTS TO SHIELD 'FAKE VOTERS' P5

'MEN JUST NEED TO GET OUT OF THE WAY' P14

Cabinet approves Rs 10,000 cr fund to promote SMEs

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday approved a Rs 10,000 crore commitment to establish an SME Growth Fund (SGF) aimed at providing direct equity investments to small and medium enterprises and helping build future Indian business champions. CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

4.9-quake hits Chamoli, tremors felt in Delhi

NEW DELHI: Tremors were felt in Delhi and adjoining areas late Tuesday after a 4.9-magnitude earthquake hit Uttarakhand's Chamoli district. According to the National Center for Seismology (NCS) — the nodal government agency monitoring earthquake activity — the epicentre was located at a depth of 13 km in Uttarakhand's Chamoli.

Harmanpreet quits, Mandhana new captain

NEW DELHI: India's only women's World Cup-winning captain Harmanpreet Kaur stepped down from leadership across all three formats on Tuesday, saying she had done her duty and was ready to "play for the love of the game again", with Smriti Mandhana taking over as captain. SEE P11

ACP Bhagat seeks hold on addl DCP charge

NEW DELHI: ACP Vivek Bhagat has asked Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar to keep on hold his additional DCP duty charge amid a pending Crime Branch inquiry into allegations of sexual harassment by a woman journalist. Bhagat, posted as SDPO Connaught Place, said he consented to withholding the charge until the inquiry concludes. SEE P2

RAHUL TAKES CENTRE STAGE IN STREET POLITICS

Opposition turns up heat on CEC in day of protest, standoff and arrests

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi was detained along with Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and several other opposition leaders on Tuesday after a day-long protest demanding a meeting with the Election Commission over the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls and seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation. The confrontation began when INDIA bloc MPs marched from Parliament towards the poll panel's headquarters but were stopped by heavy police barricades near NITI Aayog. Gandhi climbed onto a multi-layer steel barricade and waved the Tricolour before making his way into the nearby Akashvani Bhavan, where he and other leaders staged a nearly nine-hour sit-in. Police later cleared the premises and took the protesters into custody.



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi stands on a barricade while Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra holds the tricolour near Akashvani Bhawan ANI

Gandhi and other detained leaders were taken to New Police Lines at Kingsway Camp and released shortly after 10 pm, after around two hours in detention.

The protest was part of the Opposition's wider campaign against the Election Commission over the SIR exercise, which opposition parties have accused of disenfranchising eligible voters and removing names from electoral rolls. They have demanded that the exercise be scrapped, names they claim were wrongly deleted be restored and Kumar step down. Meanwhile, in a statement on Tuesday evening, the Commission said no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment with it till 4 pm. It said that around 4 pm, Delhi Police informed it CONTINUED ON P4

CLOSER LOOK

- Nine-hour sit-in held inside Akashvani Bhavan
- Rahul climbed police barricade, waved the Tricolour during march
- Opposition MPs marched from Parliament towards Election Commission
- Protesters demanded meeting with EC and CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation
- Rahul, Priyanka and other leaders detained after police cleared protest site
- Nearly 250 people detained, according to police
- Detainees taken to Kingsway Camp and other police facilities
- Rahul and others released after 10 pm, following around two hours in detention

'Treason' vs 'theatrics': Oppn, BJP exchange barbs over EC protest

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 6

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar of being involved in "vote chori", alleging that they had "hijacked the nation" and would be held accountable for "treason", while the BJP dismissed the charges as baseless and accused the Congress and its INDIA bloc allies of trying to create "anarchy" and "chaos and confusion" around the electoral process.

The rival claims came as opposition MPs were stopped by police from marching to the Election Commission office, located about 300 metres from the protest site at Akashwani Bhavan near Parliament House. The INDIA bloc had organised the march to press for the resignation of Kumar over allegations concerning the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

"Nobody is going to escape accountability," Gandhi said during a standoff with police. He told reporters that he was not concerned about the BJP's response and was protesting to protect democracy.

"NOBODY IS GOING TO ESCAPE ACCOUNTABILITY," GANDHI SAID DURING A STANDOFF WITH POLICE

"I am not interested in what the BJP says. I am standing here to protect democracy in the country. Along with me, 300 Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha MPs had come and they are also trying to protect democracy," he said.

The BJP, however, accused Gandhi and the opposition of using the protest to create disorder and revive his political standing. BJP spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi described the CONTINUED ON P4

Centre notifies 375 works under new rural job scheme

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 6

The Centre has notified 375 types of works under the new rural employment framework, expanding the scope of permissible projects by 41 per cent compared with the earlier scheme. The works under the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (VB-G RAM G) Gramin Act, 2025, focus on water security, rural infrastructure, livelihoods and disaster preparedness. SEE P6

IAF gets new chief

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit to take charge as IAF chief on October 31

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, October 6



The government on Tuesday announced that Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit, Vice Chief of the Air Staff, has been appointed the new Chief of the Air Staff and promoted to the rank of Air Chief Marshal. He will take charge as the 29th Chief of the Indian Air Force on October 31, succeeding Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, who retires on the same day.

Dixit's appointment comes as the IAF seeks to accelerate the indigenisation of its combat capabilities and expand the use of domestically produced defence equipment. He has been a strong advocate of indigenous platforms, including the Light Combat Aircraft Tejas, and is expected to play a key role in the government's push for greater self-reliance CONTINUED ON P4

CBI books Punjab CM's OSD; Mann, AAP cry foul

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 6

The CBI on Tuesday registered a corruption case against Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's Officer on Special Duty Rajbir Ghuman and five others and conducted searches at eight locations, including Mann's camp office, following directions from the Punjab and Haryana High Court, prompting Mann and his Aam Aadmi Party colleagues to accuse the BJP-led Centre of misusing central investigative agencies ahead of the state elections. The case concerns allegations that public servants and private intermediaries influenced transfers, postings, government approvals, tenders, licences and other official decisions CONTINUED ON P4

British novelist Jeffrey Archer dies at 86

AGENCIES
London, October 6

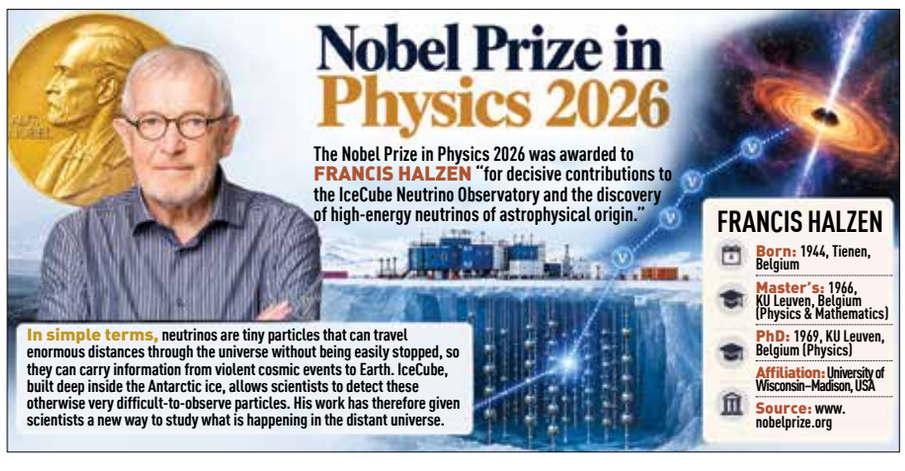
British bestselling author and former politician Jeffrey Archer has died at the age of 86, his publisher HarperCollins said. Archer died "suddenly and peacefully" at his home on Monday, a day before the worldwide release of his final novel, Adam and Eve.

Archer, whose writing career spanned five decades, sold CONTINUED ON P4

SCIENTIST WHO TRACKS COSMIC GHOST PARTICLES

Neutrino scientist Halzen wins Nobel in Physics

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Stockholm, October 6



Belgian-born scientist Francis Halzen won the Nobel Prize in Physics Tuesday for his efforts to demystify a rare group of neutrinos, tiny cosmic particles that researchers believe offer clues to how the universe evolved.

"It was a great surprise, and I obviously didn't expect it," Halzen said, speaking to the Nobel Physics Committee by phone from Italy, in a call broadcast at the news conference to announce the winner.

Halzen said it was predicted that he would win the prize, but the announcement still made him feel "strange".

"I am working on a proposal, and I hope that this prize will help get it approved," he said to chuckles CONTINUED ON P4



SECURITY TIGHTENED ACROSS NEW, CENTRAL, NORTH DELHI

Bodycams for frontline cops amid scrutiny over protests

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

Amid allegations of excesses by security personnel during protests, Delhi Police has issued body-worn cameras to its officers and personnel deployed on the frontline across the New Delhi area, an official source said on Tuesday.

The bodycams have been issued to officers deployed across the New Delhi area, particularly those involved in crowd management and security arrangements around protest sites and roads leading to the Election Commission of India office, the source said.

A police source said the bodycams would help maintain a real-time video record of events and interactions between police personnel and protesters, besides providing evidence in case allegations are made against officers on duty.

"The bodycams are important, particularly when officers are dealing with large crowds, and there are allegations from either side. The recordings can help establish what happened during a protest," the source said.

The move comes amid heightened security in the New Delhi, Central Delhi and North Delhi districts following a series of demonstrations against the Election Commission over the SIR exercise. Police and paramilitary personnel have been deployed in large numbers, while multi-layer barricades have been placed at several points to prevent protesters from entering restricted areas.

The deployment of bodycams assumes significance following complaints of alleged sexual harassment and manhandling made by three women journalists during a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar at Jantar Mantar on October 2.

The journalists alleged that police personnel behaved inappropriately with them during the protest. One of the complainants alleged that an officer sexually assaulted her.

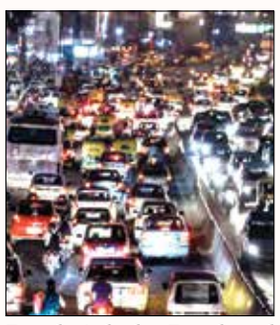
The New Delhi district police received the complaints and transferred them to the Crime Branch for a fair and impartial inquiry, an officer said.

The investigating agency is expected to examine the allegations and record statements of the complainants and other persons concerned.

The complaints have also led to protests by independent journalists and others outside Parliament Street police station, with demonstrators demanding registration of an FIR and examination of CCTV footage of the alleged incidents. No FIR had been registered in the matter, according to police sources. The use of bodycams is also aimed at strengthening accountability during law-and-order deployments, particularly as police personnel are increasingly required to manage protests involving large groups of political workers, students and civil society members. The recordings could aid inquiries into complaints against police or protesters. Delhi Police also advised journalists to carry and visibly display valid identity cards and avoid obstructing police operations.

Delhi rds gridlocked amid protest march

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 6



The 'Save Democracy' march by INDIA bloc MPs from Parliament House to the Election Commission headquarters caused severe traffic snarls in central Delhi and adjoining Delhi-NCR routes on Monday as security arrangements were intensified.

With large deployments of Delhi Police, the Rapid Action Force and paramilitary personnel, several roads in Lutyens' Delhi witnessed restrictions, diversions and blockades from around 8am, leaving commuters stuck for hours.

An area within around 500 metres of the Election Commission office was sealed, while heavy security was deployed along Parliament Street. High metal barriers were placed on roads connecting Makar Dwar of Parliament House with Raisina Road, Ashoka Road and Windsor Place. Security personnel were also stationed near Akashvani Bhawan's back gate and adjoining lanes to prevent alternate access to the protest venue.

Restrictions were also imposed around Jantar Mantar and Gol Dak Khana, where prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS were in force.

Congestion spread to Connaught Place, Patel Chowk, ITO and DDU Marg. Traffic also slowed on the Delhi-Noida routes near the DND Flyway and Kalindi Kunj.

ACP asks Delhi Police chief to keep addl DCP charge on hold

Man held for AI-generated video of ACP Bhagat: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

Assistant Commissioner of Police Vivek Bhagat, who has been accused of sexually harassing a woman journalist during a protest here, has written to the Delhi Police chief requesting that the order assigning him the current duty charge of additional DCP be kept on hold in view of an inquiry pending against him in the Crime Branch.

In his letter dated October 5, Bhagat said his current duty charge as additional DCP had been approved through an order issued earlier in the day.

"However, considering the enquiry pending against me in the Crime Branch Delhi Police regarding allegations against me by a YouTuber, I hereby give my consent to keep this order concerning only me on hold," he said in the letter addressed to the Commissioner of Police Anurag Kumar.

Bhagat, who is posted as Sub-Divisional Police Officer (SDPO) Connaught Place, signed the letter and requested that the order concerning him alone be kept on hold.

The development comes a day after the Delhi government said Bhagat's current duty charge as additional DCP would be withheld after he requested "of his own volition" not to avail the charge until a full inquiry into the alleged harassment of women journalists is conducted and "satisfactorily concluded".

KEY POINTS

- In his letter dated Oct 5, Bhagat said his current duty charge as addl DCP had been approved through an order issued earlier in the day
- 'However, considering the enquiry pending against me in the Crime Branch Delhi Police regarding allegations against me by a YouTuber, I hereby give my consent to keep this order concerning only me on hold,' he said in the letter addressed to the Commissioner of Police Anurag Kumar

Bhagat was among 12 DANIPS officers assigned the current duty charge of additional DCP on Monday. The government subsequently said the earlier order would be modified and reissued for assignment of the charge to the remaining 11 officers.

The government had also clarified that the proposal to confer the additional duty charge on the 12 officers, including Bhagat, was initiated on August 25, "much before the present set of events", and the orders were issued after due approval on October 5.

Three women journalists have accused Delhi Police personnel of sexual harassment during an October 3 protest at Jantar Mantar against alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission and the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The complaints have been received by the Delhi Police and forwarded to the Crime Branch for further inquiry.

Meanwhile, Delhi Police arrested a 24-year-old man for allegedly circulating an AI-generated video falsely portraying ACP Vivek Bhagat sexually assaulting a woman journalist, officials said on Tuesday.

Nadeem Ahmed Ameen, a resident of Palwal in Haryana, was apprehended from Mewat on Monday. Police recovered the mobile phone allegedly used to circulate the fabricated reel and said it was logged into the Instagram account '@news_aaina0776', which had around 24,000 followers and 1,226 posts.

Police said the account presented the manipulated video as genuine CCTV footage, prominently displaying Bhagat's photograph, name and designation. A case was registered at the New Delhi district Cyber Police station on October 4 under various provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. A court granted police custody of Ameen for further investigation.

Investigators are probing the source of funding and whether the incident was part of a larger conspiracy to tarnish Delhi Police's image and spread disaffection during the protests.

North-eastern woman 'harassed, friends attacked at five-star hotel'

New Delhi, October 6

Three men allegedly harassed a north-eastern woman and tried to forcibly pull her into their Mercedes car at a five star hotel in New Delhi's Chanakyapuri area, following which they assaulted her friends with hockey sticks and iron rods when they intervened, police said on Tuesday. The incident took place around 3.30 am on Sunday at the parking lot of a five star hotel, police said. According to the complaint, the woman, who is a native of Nagaland, had gone to the hotel with her friend. While they were returning from the washroom, the three accused, who were travelling in a white Mercedes car, allegedly approached them and tried to stop them and forcibly pull the woman into the vehicle. MPOST

Supertech projects get NBCC push

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

NBCC has floated 25 tenders worth Rs 9,620.33 crore for construction and related works across 16 stalled Supertech residential projects in Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Uttarakhand and Karnataka.

The projects comprise nearly 50,000 housing units. NBCC was appointed PMC in December 2024, with the Supreme Court upholding its mandate in February 2026.

Delhiite attacks live-in partner with acid after break up: Police

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

A 24-year-old woman was allegedly attacked with acid by her former live-in partner in northeast Delhi's Bhajanpura on Tuesday after she broke up with him, police said.

The woman, who was on her way to work when the incident occurred, suffered serious burn injuries to her face, chest and thigh, and was initially taken to Jag Pravesh Chandra Hospital. She was later referred to GTB Hospital in view of the severity of her injuries, police said.

According to police, the woman was walking to work in Gandhi Nagar around 6 am when the accused allegedly approached her from behind near a local crossing and threw acid on her before fleeing the spot.

The woman, in severe pain, sought help from an around 80-year-old man, whose left hand also suffered minor burn injuries during the incident, police said.

She somehow managed to return to her rented accommodation, following which the landlord's son informed police. A police team reached the spot and rushed her to the hospital.

During the investigation, police found that the woman had been living separately from her family and had been staying on rent in the Bhajanpura area for around two-and-a-half to three years. She had allegedly been in a live-in relationship with the accused for around three years, officials said. The woman had distanced herself from the accused around three months ago, following which he allegedly attacked her with acid, police said.

Police have identified the accused and formed teams to arrest him. The woman's family is from Uttar Pradesh, while her aunt occasionally visited her.

Jantar Mantar assault case: Regular bail granted to Swatantra Bhardwaj

New Delhi, October 6



A Delhi court on Tuesday granted regular bail to self-styled Hindutva influencer Swatantra Bhardwaj in a case concerning the alleged assault of the father of a student activist during the CJP protest at Jantar Mantar.

Additional Sessions Judge Saurabh Pratap Singh Laler passed the order after earlier giving Bhardwaj interim bail for three weeks and observing his conduct during the period.

The detailed bail order is awaited.

The court on September 15 granted Bhardwaj interim bail for three weeks, saying his conduct would be taken into account while deciding his plea for regular bail.

While granting interim relief, the court imposed several conditions on Bhardwaj, including a direction not to post, publish or discuss the case, his defence or the complainant's family on social media or any other media platform. He was also directed not to contact the complainant, his daughter or any witness and not to interfere with the evidence in the case.

While granting the interim bail, the court had stressed that bail was an expression of the court's trust and "not a trophy to be displayed".

The court had also cautioned Bhardwaj against any public celebration following his release on bail.

The case relates to the alleged assault of the father of a student activist during the protests organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) at Jantar Mantar. PTI

Hindu Rao nurses intensify protest, seek more nursing officers

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 6

PROTEST BEGAN WITH A BLACK-RIBBON DEMONSTRATION FROM SEPT 28 TO OCT 4

Nurses at Delhi's Hindu Rao Hospital have been protesting since September 28 over a shortage of nursing staff, which they say has increased the workload on existing personnel and is affecting patient care.

Delhi Nurses Union president Vibha Singh said the hospital has 300 sanctioned nursing posts, but only 62 nursing officers are currently working, leaving a large number of vacancies. She said some wards have 40 to 50 patients being attended to by a single nursing officer, placing a heavy burden on the available staff.

The protest began with a black-ribbon demonstration from September 28 to October 4, with nurses continuing their duties while wearing black ribbons. Since October 5, they have been holding two-hour protests, scheduled to continue until October 11.

Singh said the staff shortage was also affecting nurses' health and family lives. The union said no official communication or action had followed despite the protests. If the issue remains unresolved, nurses have threatened to begin a total strike from October 12.

SPUWAC trains 500 NCC cadets

New Delhi, October 6

The Delhi Police's Special Police Unit for Women and Children (SPUWAC) on Tuesday concluded a six-day self-defence training programme for around 500 NCC cadets at the NCC Headquarters in Safdarjung Enclave.

Held from October 1 to 6, the programme focused on personal safety, situational awareness, preventive measures, confidence-building and appropriate responses during emergencies.

Three SPUWAC personnel provided practical training to the cadets, who demonstrated the techniques they had learnt during the closing ceremony.

The initiative comes amid concerns over sexual violence against women in Delhi, with several cases reported in the city in recent days. MPOST

EXPECTED TO SERVE 55K PASSENGERS DAILY IN OPENING YR

Rs 3,500-crore APM planned to connect Delhi Airport terminals

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6



APM IS GENERALLY A DRIVERLESS TRANSIT SYSTEM THAT CAN FERRY PEOPLE FROM ONE POINT TO ANOTHER

Delhi airport expects to have the Automated People Mover (APM) or the transit system connecting all the terminals by 2030, with an estimated investment of Rs 3,500 crore, officials said on Tuesday.

The APM is part of the airport's ten-year master plan till 2036 and during this period, the overall annual passenger handling capacity is projected to rise to 125 million, which can even go up to 129 million.

APM, which is generally a driverless transit system that can ferry people from one point to another, will help in easing the congestion in and around the Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA), which is also the country's busiest airport.

Operated by Delhi International Airport Ltd (DIAL), the airport has three terminals – T1, T2 and T3 – and four runways as well as an elevated cross taxiway.

DIAL CEO Pradeep Panicker on Tuesday said the proposed inter-terminal connectivity through APM is expected to be ready by 2030, briefing reporters in the national capital about the master plan.

The idea of APM has been in discussions for the past few years and the work is in progress in terms of finalising the design and other elements. Officials said APM would be set up with an investment of around Rs 3,500 crore.

The APM, which will connect six stations, will stretch 7.3 kilometres and the travel time between T1 and T3 will be around 13 minutes, the officials said.

While T2 and T3 are close by, T1 is a few kilometres away and currently, passengers who want to take a flight from T1 after landing at T3 or vice versa have to go by road to reach either of the terminals. Meanwhile, DIAL is awaiting approval from the authorities for airside transfer of passengers from T3 to T1 by bus.

Apart from the three passenger terminals, the APM will also connect the cargo terminal and Aerocity, and through one of the stations, people can connect with the Delhi Metro lines. They also said the APM is projected to have a ridership of 55,000 people per day in the opening year. A decision on charges for non-flyers using the APM is pending. DIAL plans to raise airport capacity to 125 million passengers, including 86 million domestic and 39 million international.

Swiss Prez reviews Noida Int'l Airport

DIPIKA KIROLA
Greater Noida, October 6



Swiss President Guy Parmelin on Tuesday visited Noida International Airport in Jewar, reviewing its infrastructure, cargo facilities and operational plans during a nearly two-hour visit.

Parmelin arrived around 1pm with a high-level delegation and inspected the cargo terminal and other key facilities. Officials briefed the delegation on the airport's development, proposed operations, passenger facilities and expansion plans.

Discussions also covered potential international air connectivity between Zurich Airport and Noida International Airport, officials said.

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BOOST TO PRIMARY HEALTHCARE

Delhi govt doubles ASHA pay, expands newborn screening

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 6



In a push to strengthen primary healthcare and early detection of health disorders, the Delhi government on Tuesday announced a doubling of the monthly incentive for 6,690 ASHA workers and expanded newborn screening under Mission ANMOL to cover 63 congenital diseases, as Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched multiple health initiatives at Thyagraj Stadium.

The initiatives were launched during the 'ASHA Sammelan-2026 and ASHA Samman Samaroh', organised under the Seva Sankalp Abhiyan. The event also saw the launch of the Nursing Home Management System portal and the virtual inauguration of the State Organ and Tissue Transplant Organisation (SOTTO) building at GB Pant Hospital.

Under the revised incentive, ASHA workers will now receive Rs 6,000 per month instead of Rs 3,000. The government said the move recognises the contribution of workers who take healthcare services and welfare schemes to households.

Sandhu said the initiatives would strengthen Delhi's healthcare delivery through technology and public health systems. "Modern technology, effective public health systems and a humane approach will further strengthen Delhi's healthcare system," he said. He also highlighted the role of ASHA workers in reaching pregnant women, children and families and said the increase in their incentive recognised their contribution.

Mission ANMOL has been expanded to screen newborns for 63 congenital, genetic and metabolic disorders within 24 to 72 hours of birth. The government aims to increase annual screening coverage from around 1.5 lakh to 2.5 lakh newborns. More than 75,000 newborns have already been screened and over 700 children have received timely treatment, according to the government. The SOTTO building at GB Pant Hospital will strengthen coordination and institutional mechanisms for organ and tissue donation and transplantation in Delhi. Gupta also appealed to residents to spread awareness about organ and body donation.

"Organ donation is not merely a medical procedure but a symbol of humanity, compassion and respect for life," Gupta said, adding that she had registered for body donation through the SOTTO portal. The Nursing Home Management System portal will bring registration and renewal of private nursing homes online, reducing paperwork and repeated visits to government offices while improving monitoring and record management.

Barapullah P-III traffic woes trigger flow review

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 6


REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

Barely days after the Barapullah Phase III flyover was opened for commuters, persistent traffic bottlenecks on the newly operational corridor have prompted the Public Works Department (PWD) to examine possible changes to its traffic flow, officials said.

The department held discussions with the Delhi Traffic Police and the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) to assess whether any portion of the elevated corridor could be modified to improve movement. However, officials said no structural change has been finalised so far.

"A meeting was held with PWD officials, Traffic Police and the National Highways Authority of India to find if there is scope to restructure any part of the flyover to ease the congestion. But no final decision has been taken yet," an official said.

The flyover, inaugurated on September 29 after several delays, connects Mayur Vihar Phase-I with Sarai Kale Khan along the Ring Road. It forms part of the wider Barapullah network, extending the elevated corridor towards the AIIMS roundabout.

The project was expected to provide a smoother alternative for motorists travelling between east and south Delhi and ease pressure on stretches around DND and Akshardham. However, traffic build-up has been reported regularly since the corridor became operational.

Officials attributed part of the congestion to traffic merging at the junction between the newly opened stretch and the existing Barapullah corridor. The ongoing NHAI work related to the integration of the Delhi-Mumbai Motorway with the Outer Ring Road near Sarai Kale Khan has also emerged as another factor affecting traffic movement.

"We have noticed the complaints filed; an effort is underway to figure out a solution," the officer said.

Traffic police officials have also observed that congestion on the newly opened corridor was not immediately reflected on Google Maps. As a result, motorists continued to take the route expecting quicker travel, adding to the traffic volume. The situation has been particularly noticeable for commuters travelling from east Delhi towards south Delhi, with delays being reported during regular commuting hours.

The PWD is now assessing traffic patterns at the merging points and the surrounding road network before deciding whether any changes are required. Officials said the exercise would focus on identifying measures that could improve vehicle movement without compromising the functioning of the newly opened corridor.

The Barapullah Phase III project had been positioned as a key infrastructure intervention to improve connectivity between east and south Delhi. Its traffic performance is now under review as agencies assess how the new elevated stretch is interacting with existing roads and ongoing construction activity.

MCD carries out 29 demolitions

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 6



The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Tuesday carried out 29 demolition actions across its 12 zones as part of its ongoing enforcement drive against unauthorised constructions, dangerous buildings and violations of building norms. Seven properties were sealed and five demolition orders were also issued during the exercise, according to the MCD. The action was taken against violations of the Master Plan of Delhi (MPD), Building Bye-Laws and other applicable regulations.

Major demolition actions were carried out in Shalimar Bagh, Mayur Kunj, Patparganj, Ambedkar Nagar and Shahdara, among other areas. Field teams were deployed across the city to identify and act against unauthorised constructions and other violations.

The civic body said its enforcement teams were maintaining vigilance across all 12 zones and taking action in accordance with prescribed rules. The exercise is part of the MCD's continuing efforts to address construction violations and buildings considered unsafe.

On Monday, the civic body had carried out 31 demolition actions and sealed seven properties during its enforcement drive. The MCD said unauthorised construction and violations of building norms would ot be permitted within its jurisdiction. Officials have been directed to maintain strict vigilance and initiate action against violations under the applicable provisions. The civic body said the enforcement drive would continue across Delhi, with a focus on unauthorised constructions, dangerous buildings and other violations that could pose risks to public safety.

Discoms offer quick power connections

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

With Delhi gearing up for the festive season, power discoms BRPL and BYPL have introduced same-day temporary electricity connections for Durga Puja, Ramlilas, Diwali melas, weddings and other events, offering organisers an alternative to diesel generator sets.

Under the 'Tatkal' service, eligible consumers can get temporary electricity connections within 24 hours, subject to completion of prescribed formalities and technical feasibility. The service has reduced the processing time from up to seven days earlier to within a day.

A BSES spokesperson said the initiative was aimed at making festive events safer while reducing dependence on diesel generators. "Festivals are a time of celebration and togetherness, and reliable electricity plays an important role in making these occasions safe and enjoyable. Through our 'Tatkal' service, we are leveraging technology and streamlined processes to facilitate temporary electricity connections within 24 hours," the spokesperson said.

"Besides making the process more convenient for consumers, these connections also provide a cleaner alternative to diesel generators and support Delhi's efforts to reduce pollution," the spokesperson added.

Consumers can apply for the temporary connections through the BSES website, BRPL Power App, BYPL Connect, WhatsApp, customer care centres and Digi Seva Kendras. Applications can also be made through the Delhi government's Single Window System at the office of the concerned District Magistrate. For BRPL consumers, applications and queries can be made through WhatsApp at 8800919123 or the call centre number 19123. BYPL consumers can use WhatsApp number 8745999808 or call 19122. BSES said payments for temporary connections can be made digitally, allowing organisers to complete the process without physical paperwork or visits.

The discoms have also placed their Operations and Maintenance teams on high alert in view of the expected increase in electricity demand during the festive period. Teams will monitor the distribution network and remain prepared to respond to localised power-related issues during major celebrations.

BSES urged organisers of Ramlilas, Durga Puja events, Diwali melas, weddings and other gatherings to opt for authorised temporary electricity connections instead of unauthorised wiring or diesel generators.

Briefs

MCD seeks ₹60 cr annual grant

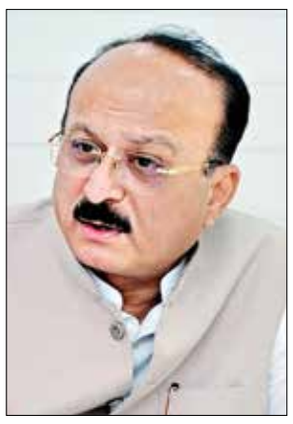
NEW DELHI: Citing "paucity of funds", the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has sought an annual grant-in-aid of Rs 60 crore from Delhi government to deploy drone surveillance and set up 21 dedicated enforcement squads across its 12 zones to check illegal construction in informal colonies, according to an official document. According to a business item passed at the latest meeting of the MCD House on September 30, the civic body has submitted a proposal to the Delhi government's urban development department seeking Rs 7 crore annually for quarterly three-dimensional drone mapping and Rs 53 crore a year for running round-the-clock demolition cells equipped with heavy machinery and specialised labour.

CAQM mandates expansion of pan-tilt-zoom cams

NEW DELHI: The Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas (CAQM) has issued an order mandating expansion of pan-tilt-zoom (PTZ) cameras at industries in the National Capital Region. The move aims to strengthen vigilance, monitoring and compliance by industries, particularly in view of the adverse impact of industrial emissions on air quality in the NCR and adjoining areas.

581 Class 9 girls get bicycles under Vidya Vahini

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6



Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday distributed bicycles to 581 Class 9 girl students at two government schools in A-Block, Janakpuri, under the Delhi government's Vidya Vahini Yojana.

The bicycles were distributed to students of Government Sarvodaya Kanya Vidyalaya and Government Girls Senior Secondary School in the area. Under the scheme, the government has decided to provide high-quality branded bicycles to around 1.40 lakh Class 9 girl students across Delhi. So far, around 18,000 students have received bicycles.

Addressing students, parents and school officials, Sood said the initiative was aimed at promoting independence among girls beyond facilitating their daily commute.

"For me, this joy is not merely that bicycles are being given to our daughters. My joy lies in the fact that while we perhaps could not attach wings to their dreams, we have given them wheels," he said.

He said bicycles would give students greater freedom and self-reliance to travel to school and other nearby places without depending on family members. He also urged mothers to encourage their daughters to cycle and build confidence in travelling independently.

Sood also highlighted infrastructure and education-related works in government schools. He said two new foot-over bridges had been approved near C-1 and Jeevan Park Som Bazaar on Pankha Road to address traffic and improve pedestrian safety.

The minister said schools were being equipped with 75-inch smart displays to promote experiential learning under the National Education Policy 2020. Modern ICT laboratories with 40 computers and specialised language labs have also been provided.

Under the NEEEV project, student teams are being given grants of up to Rs 20,000 for innovation projects, including drones, smartwatches and mobile applications.

Sood also assured that the around 50-year-old school building would be completely rebuilt during the government's current five-year term.

Under the Madan Mohan Malaviya Education Mission, the government is providing two years of free coaching through institutes such as Aakash and Narayana for competitive examinations including NEET, CUET, CA, CWA and CLAT.

He urged students to focus on conceptual understanding rather than marks alone and aim for admission to leading universities through CUET.

CM slams AAP govt in Pb over stubble burning

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday slammed the Punjab government over the resumption of stubble burning in Tarn Taran, recalling former AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal's promise to stop the practice within a year. In a post on X, Gupta said Kejriwal had promised, "give me one year, and I'll stop the burning of stubble in Punjab", but alleged that years had passed while farmers continued to wait for help.

She alleged that instead of freeing farmers from the compulsion to burn stubble, the AAP government had "left them to fend for themselves". "Stubble burning has started again in Tarn Taran," she said.

Gupta said the central government had provided funds, machines and subsidies to address the issue, but alleged that the Bhagwant Mann-led government had failed to make arrangements on the ground.

AQI 'MODERATE' AT 179

Weather stations across Capital log above-normal temperatures

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

KEY POINTS

» Across the 44 air quality monitoring stations, the one at Dwarka Sector 8 recorded AQI at 305, in 'very poor' category, while 11 recorded 'poor' readings — Mundka and Narela logging the worst at 266 and 241, respectively — and the remaining 32 logged 'moderate' air quality

» The Dwarka Sector 8 station had last recorded 'very poor' air quality on May 25, when its reading stood at 322



Delhi recorded above-normal maximum and minimum temperatures Tuesday, while the average air quality index (AQI) stood at 179, in 'moderate' category, with one station logging 'very poor' air quality beyond AQI 300.

Across the 44 air quality monitoring stations, the one at Dwarka Sector 8 recorded AQI at 305, in 'very poor' category, while 11 recorded 'poor' readings – Mundka and Narela logging the worst at 266 and 241, respectively – and the remaining 32 logged 'moderate' air quality.

The Dwarka Sector 8 station had last recorded 'very poor' air quality on May 25, when its reading stood at 322.

According to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB), an AQI between 0 and 50 is considered 'good', 51-100 'satisfactory', 101-200 'moderate', 201-300 'poor', 301-400 'very poor' and 401-500 'severe'.

According to the Air Quality Early Warning System, air quality is likely to remain in 'moderate' category till October 9, while it may dip to 'poor' or remain 'moderate' over the subsequent six days.

Most weather stations across the city recorded above-normal maximum temperatures Tuesday. Safdarjung recorded the highest maximum temperature of 36.8 degrees Celsius, 2.6 degrees above normal, followed by Lodi Road and Ridge at 35.8 degrees Celsius each, with departures of 2.8 and 1.3 degrees, respectively. Ayanagar recorded 35.6 degrees Celsius, 1.1 degrees above normal, while Palam recorded 34 degrees Celsius, 0.4 degrees below normal.

Safdarjung recorded a minimum temperature of 25.2 degrees Celsius, 2.9 degrees above normal, followed by Lodi Road at 24.1 degrees Celsius, 3.1 degrees above normal. Palam and Ayanagar recorded 23.6 degrees Celsius each, with departures of 1.3 and 1.6 degrees, respectively, while Ridge recorded the lowest minimum of 21.5 degrees Celsius, one degree below normal.

No rainfall was recorded at these weather stations during the day.

For Wednesday, the India Meteorological Department has forecast a minimum temperature of 22 degrees Celsius and a maximum of 34 degrees Celsius, with partly cloudy skies.

Kirari gets ₹263-cr waterlogging fix

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

In a move aimed at tackling recurring monsoon waterlogging in parts of west and northwest Delhi, the city government on Tuesday approved a Rs 263.45-crore project to build a 4.5-km drain along the railway line in Kirari, with work targeted for completion by December 2027.

The Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC), chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, cleared the project, which will have a design discharge capacity of 760 cusecs. The drain will start from Mundka Halt station and connect to the Supplementary Drain, serving as a major outfall for rainwater accumulating in the surrounding areas.

The project is expected to benefit residents across four Assembly constituencies, Kirari, Mundka, Bawana and Nangloi Jat, besides improving drainage in more than 70 unauthorised colonies in Kirari.

"Waterlogging is not merely about water accumulating for a short period, it directly affects people's mobility, businesses, homes and everyday lives," Gupta said, adding that the government had taken the project forward as a permanent solution to the problem.

The Chief Minister said the Railways had also approved the project following efforts by the Delhi government. "Previous governments did not work with the required seriousness to resolve waterlogging in the area, but our government has made it a priority and initiated work on the project," she said.

Several areas in Mundka, including Rani Khera Industrial Area, Venu Enclave, Ratan Park, Rajdhani Park, JJ Cluster Colony, Rajendra Park Extension, Ram Nagar, Kunwar Singh Nagar and Nilothi village, are expected to benefit from the drainage network.

Man sexually assaults minor; beaten to death by crowd

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Nagpur, October 6

A 35-year-old man was beaten to death by a large group of people after he was accused of taking a nine-year-old girl to his house and sexually assaulting her in Nagpur city, police said on Tuesday.

The incident took place on Monday between 8 pm and 9.30 pm in an area under Pardi Police Station limits, they said. According to police, the girl was playing near her home when the accused took her to his house nearby.

PANAMA-FLAGGED COMMERCIAL VESSEL WAS HIT BY PROJECTILE

India condemns Hormuz ship attack that injured 11 Indian crew members

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

Eleven Indian crew members were injured on Tuesday after a Panama-flagged commercial vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz, prompting a strong condemnation from India.

The vessel, MT On Peace, carried 19 crew members, including 17 Indian nationals.

In total, 12 crew members -- 11 of them Indian -- sustained injuries in the strike, according to the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA).

"We condemn the attack earlier today on a Panama-flagged commercial vessel MT On Peace off the coast of Oman, where it was struck by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz," the MEA said in a statement.

"Of the total crew of 19, 17 are Indian nationals. It is learnt that 12 crew members have been injured, including 11 Indian nationals," it said.

The MEA said continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region remain a "cause of deep concern" for India. "We reiterate our call for an immediate cessation of such attacks in the interests of peace and stability in the region," it said.

"The targeting of commercial shipping, seafarers and civilian infrastructure in the region must end, and navigation and commerce through international waterways must be restored at the earliest," it added.

The MEA said the sailors of the vessel were evacuated with the help of Omani authorities.

"With the assistance of Omani authorities, the injured crew have since been evacuated and are receiving medical treatment in Khasab, Oman. We thank the Omani authorities for their valuable support," it said.

HIGHLIGHTS

- In total, 12 crew members -- 11 of them Indian -- sustained injuries in the strike, according to the MEA
- The MEA said continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region remain a "cause of deep concern" for India

India and B'desh seek to break ice with trade, visa talks

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

India and Bangladesh are working to arrange the meeting of institutional mechanisms in areas such as trade and consular affairs as part of efforts to normalise ties.

A Bangladeshi team is set to travel to New Delhi on Wednesday for a meeting of the joint working group on trade during October 8 to 9, the people said on condition of anonymity. The two sides are also working on dates for a meeting of the joint working group on consular matters, which Dhaka will host, they said.

These efforts aim to restore a semblance of normalcy to bilateral relations, even as the two countries continue to address more serious irritants, the people said.

Bilateral ties hit an all-time low after student-led protests ousted the Sheikh Hasina government in August 2024 and replaced it with an interim administration led by Muhammad Yunus.

From page 1

Opposition

that a delegation of MPs led by Gandhi wished to meet it and submit a memorandum. It later learnt the delegation had 240 parliamentarians and the proposed venue was the Parliament House Annexe.

The Commission called the request "unusual". It said that under a procedure laid down in 2025, delegations seek an appointment through an authorised representative, and meetings are held at a mutually agreed time on the Commission's premises. It said it offered to send its senior-most officer on duty to receive the memorandum, a step it described as unprecedented, but the MPs declined. "Any political party may, at any time, request a meeting with the Election Commission," it said.

The day began around 10 am when opposition MPs assembled for the march from Parliament towards the Election Commission office on Ashoka Road. Police had already put extensive security arrangements in place, with barricades erected across the route and personnel deployed around key points in central Delhi.

The protesters raised slogans such as "Vote Chor, Gaddi Chhod" and carried placards and cutouts depicting Gyanesh Kumar. Their immediate demand was to reach the Commission and meet the election commissioners.

The march was stopped near the NITI Aayog office. Several opposition MPs were detained as police prevented the group from moving towards the poll panel's headquarters. Among those taken into custody at the initial stage were Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Trinamool Congress leaders Abhishek Banerjee, Derek O'Brien and Mahua Moitra, and CPI(M) MP John Brittas.

As the detentions began, Gandhi remained at the front of the protest. He climbed onto the heavy metal barricades, stood above the police cordon and waved the national flag before moving through the security line.

The Congress leader then headed towards the reception entrance of Akashvani Bhavan, the All India Radio headquarters located about 200 metres from the Election Commission office. The move shifted the centre of the protest away from the main route and caught several opposition MPs, including some Congress leaders, by surprise.

Gandhi first spoke to Priyanka Gandhi, who was seated inside one of the police buses after being detained. He then made his way towards the entrance of Akashvani Bhavan.

Staff at the reception initially tried to prevent him from entering, resulting in a tense standoff. Gandhi eventually entered the premises accompanied by his security personnel. Congress general secretary K C Venugopal and Rajya Sabha MP Pawan Khera subsequently reached the gate and sought entry.

New Delhi Deputy Commissioner of Police Sachin Sharma arrived at the spot and held talks with the leaders. Venugopal, Khera and others were eventually allowed inside.

By around noon, the protest had turned into a sit-in. Mats were laid out inside the Akashvani Bhavan premises as Gandhi and other Congress leaders settled down. Priyanka Gandhi spoke with police officials while her brother remained seated with the protesters.

Congress leaders including Deepender Hooda, Charanjit Singh Channi, Praniti Shinde, K C Venugopal and Pawan Khera joined the gathering. The number of protesters inside the compound grew as opposition leaders who had initially been detained were released and returned to the site.

The standoff continued through the afternoon. Police remained positioned around the premises, preventing the protesters from moving towards the Election Commission office, while Congress workers gathered outside and raised slogans in support of Gandhi.

At around 2.30 pm, reporters spoke to Gandhi through the grille of the premises. Defending the decision to remain inside, he said, "I don't care what the BJP says. I am standing here to protect democracy."

Gandhi alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and Gyanesh Kumar had "hijacked" the country through what he described as "vote chori".

"What has been done to the country is treason. Be it PM Modi, Shah, the RSS chief or Gyanesh Kumar, none will be spared," he alleged.

Earlier, Gandhi had said that his immediate objective was to meet the Chief Election Commissioner.

"All I want to do is meet the Chief Election Commissioner and tell him that he has done 'vote chori'. I can continue to sit here. I am comfortable here," he said.

The protest continued until the evening, turning into a prolonged standoff between the opposition leaders and police. Gandhi remained inside the premises for several hours as the police waited for the gathering to disperse.

The sit-in ended after 8 pm, when a large number of police personnel cleared the site. Officers pushed Gandhi and others into police vans and buses as the MPs resisted. There was jostling and scuffling, and one policeman was seen locking his arms around Gandhi from behind. Those detained included Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Venugopal, Khera, Amrinder Singh Raja Warring, Channi, Derek O'Brien, Mahua Moitra and a Samajwadi Party MP.

Reports differed on the numbers. Police said nearly 250 people were detained over the day. Citing PTI, one report put the figure at around 50 MPs after a scuffle between Congress workers and police. The detainees were driven in different vehicles to various police stations and to the New Police Lines at Kingsway Camp. They were released a little after 10 pm, the party said.

In a Hindi post on X soon after he was detained, Gandhi wrote: "To save the traitors of democracy, the remnants of democracy have been dragged. There will be accountability - not a single traitor will be spared." He alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah and RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat had "hijacked" the country through "vote chori", with help from Kumar.

The Congress said Gandhi had been "dragged away from a peaceful sit-in protest" and called it a "sign of a regime that knows its exit is imminent". Party general secretary Jairam Ramesh said the Delhi Police is controlled by a "co-conspirator of the murder of democracy". Party president Mallikarjun Kharge claimed that "considerable nervousness is evident in the behaviour of the Prime Minister and the Home Minister".

The march was the latest in a series of protests demanding Kumar's resignation since a September 25 Indian Express report that suggested irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and differences among the election commissioners. The opposition has also sought the scrapping of the SIR and the restoration of names it says were wrongly deleted. In July, Gandhi led a sit-in outside the Prime Minister's residence over police action against students protesting the NEET paper leak. In August, he held a six-hour dharna at the Parliament Street police station over an alleged pellet gun injury to a youth during the July 20 protest.

Biju Janata Dal MPs, who are not part of the INDIA bloc, joined Tuesday's march. The DMK and AAP, both former bloc members, stayed away.

Cabinet

The decision was taken at a meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw briefed reporters on the initiative.

The fund, announced in the Union Budget 2026-27, will provide growth-oriented capital to SMEs operating in manufacturing, services, technology, innovation-led industries and strategic value chains.

Under the framework, the government will commit Rs 10,000 crore to an Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) set up under the SGF.

The initiative is intended to provide SMEs with long-term capital to expand their operations, increase manufacturing capacity and adopt new technologies. It is also expected to help businesses enter international markets, become part of global supply chains and make strategic investments.

According to an official release, the fund will support the creation of Indian enterprises capable of growing into larger and globally competitive companies.

The government expects the investment mechanism to help address the capital needs of growth-oriented SMEs while supporting expansion across sectors that are important to India's economic and industrial development.

EC protest

demonstration as "theatrics on the street" and said Gandhi was making "baseless" allegations of vote theft instead of working to regain public confidence in the Congress.

Trivedi also questioned the opposition's position on voters identified as "absent, shifted, dead and duplicate", asking whether the Congress wanted such names to retain voting rights without verification.

"How many times has Rahul Gandhi ever camped in a poll-bound state for at least one week or two weeks and campaigned for his party?" Trivedi asked, calling Gandhi a "kaamchor" or slacker.

The BJP said the march was another attempt by the Congress to "relaunch" Gandhi by creating "chaos and confusion" over the SIR exercise. The party deployed senior spokespersons to counter the Congress's allegations, while several other leaders accused Gandhi of spreading what they described as false claims.

Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said the opposition was using allegations against constitutional institutions to vent its frustration over electoral defeats and malign their image.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju also hit out at Gandhi, saying he should focus on serving people and winning their mandate instead of blaming the Election Commission for electoral setbacks.

Rijiju further alleged that foreign forces were pushing narratives aimed at discrediting constitutional institutions and misleading people. "The Congress, at the very least, should not propagate these anti-India narratives," he said.

Trivedi also accused the Congress of targeting democratic institutions because it could not accept the functioning of what he called a "genuine democracy". He alleged that the party, which he described as an "internally dynastic setup", had made "baseless, meaningless and absurd" allegations against various constitutional institutions, including the judiciary, over the past 12 years.

IAF

in military aviation.

Born on December 9, 1966, Dixit was commissioned into the fighter stream of the Indian Air Force on December 6, 1986. An alumnus of the National Defence Academy, Defence Services Staff College in Bangladesh and National Defence College, he has flown more than 3,500 hours on several aircraft, including the Mirage-2000, MiG series, Jaguar, IL-78, Hawk and Tejas.

Dixit is an Experimental Test Pilot and a Qualified Flying Instructor. During his nearly four-decade career, he has held several operational and staff appointments. Before becoming Vice Chief of the Air Staff, he served as Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman, Chiefs of Staff Committee, and Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Central Air Command.

He has been involved in several operations and exercises, including Safed Sagar, Rakshak, Cope India and Sindoor. His experience as a fighter pilot and test pilot is expected to be significant as the IAF works on fleet modernisation and reducing dependence on foreign-made aircraft.

Dixit has received several service honours, including the Vayu Sena Medal in 2006, Vishisht Seva Medal in 2011, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2023 and Param Vishisht Seva Medal in 2026.

His appointment comes at a time when the IAF is balancing the need to modernise its fleet with efforts to expand indigenous capabilities.

CBI books

for financial gains. Mann alleged that the CBI and Enforcement Directorate were being used to defame his government, while AAP leaders called the action politically motivated and linked it to the BJP's efforts to gain a foothold in Punjab.

Besides Ghuman, the CBI has named Nitin Gohal, Jitin Gohal alias Raja, Romi Raja Mahajan, Bir Devinder and R.S. Nagra as accused, along with unidentified public servants and private individuals. The agency is examining allegations that the network influenced the transfers and postings of government officers, including IAS and IPS officials, as well as departmental proceedings, policy formulation, tenders, licensing and other administrative decisions.

The probe also covers land and property-related matters, including land-use conversion, property disputes and revenue issues. The allegations being investigated include claims that interventions in such matters were facilitated in return for monetary and other benefits. The CBI is also looking into whether drafts of government orders and policies were shared with private individuals before their official release.

The agency's action followed an order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court on a public interest litigation filed by advocate Nikhil Saraf. The petition sought an independent probe into allegations raised by the Enforcement Directorate in letters to the Punjab DGP. The high court said the material provided by the ED prima facie indicated the involvement of high public officials in alleged corruption and warranted registration of an FIR and a proper investigation.

The ED had written three letters to the Punjab DGP seeking registration of a case against alleged middleman Nitin Gohal and others. Its allegations emerged from a money laundering investigation linked to alleged fake consent letters used to obtain Change of Land Use approval in a housing society matter. The ED had searched premises linked to Gohal, Ajay Sehgal of Indian Cooperative House Building Society, the Suntec City Project and others in May, and later submitted a 200-page affidavit before the high court.

Following the court's directions and the ED's report, the CBI searched eight locations in Chandigarh, Mohali, Gurdaspur, Ludhiana, Patiala, Sangrur and Jalandhar. Laptops, mobile phones and documents were seized and are being examined for evidence of alleged bribery, manipulation and other wrongdoing. The agency said it was analysing electronic and documentary evidence to establish the nature of the alleged transactions and the roles of those named in the case.

Mann, however, accused the BJP of preparing for the Punjab elections through central agencies. "CBI raided my camp office... now ED and CBI will be misused in Punjab, so that Punjab govt and me can be defamed," he posted on X, adding that the BJP was nervous over the support he was receiving.

AAP National Convenor Arvind Kejriwal described the action as a sign of "panic" ahead of the elections and accused the BJP of trying to fight the Punjab polls with the help of the ED and CBI. He claimed Punjabis would respond through the elections. Other AAP leaders, including Manish Sisodia, Sanjay Singh, Harpal Singh Cheema, Aman Arora, Saurabh Bharadwaj and Anurag Dhanda, also accused the BJP of political misuse of investigative agencies and said the party was seeking to gain an electoral foothold in Punjab. The source material does not include a response from the BJP.

Jeffrey Archer

about 300 million books worldwide. He spent 14 years and five months on the UK's Sunday Times bestseller lists and more than five years on The New York Times bestseller lists.

His first novel, Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less, was published in 1976 and drew on his experience of financial difficulties after poor investments. He later became one of Britain's best-known commercial novelists, with works including Kane and Abel.

Archer also had a political career in the Conservative Party and rose through its ranks under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher. In 1992, he was appointed to the House of Lords by Prime Minister John Major.

His political career was disrupted by a perjury conviction. While campaigning to become mayor of London in 1999, allegations resurfaced that he had fabricated an alibi during a 1987 libel case against the Daily Star. Archer had won £500,000 in damages from the newspaper, but a jury later found that he had lied in court. He was sentenced to four years in prison in 2001 and released in 2003 after serving more than two years.

Archer later chronicled his prison experience in the three-volume A Prison Diary, covering his time at prisons including HMP Belmarsh and North Sea Camp.

His political interests also included reforming royal succession laws.

His campaign for equal succession rights for royal daughters preceded the Succession to the Crown Act 2013.

Adam and Eve tells the story of two children born on the same day into different social classes. Archer described it as "the most satisfying thing I have ever written."

He is survived by his wife of 60 years, Dame Mary Archer, their two sons, two granddaughters and three grandsons.

Halzen

from the audience.

Neutrinos are tiny cosmic particles with no electrical charge and extraordinarily small mass, making them difficult to detect. Yet they are everywhere: They spew from stars like the sun, and trillions zip through our bodies every second.

Scientists cannot glimpse the mysterious ghost particles zooming around on their own, so they measure what happens when the particles collide with other bits of matter. Neutrinos bump into other particles only rarely, so scientists build large detectors to improve their odds of catching collisions.

Halzen had the idea to turn the vast Antarctic ice into such a detector. The Nobel committee said his work was instrumental to the construction of the IceCube Neutrino Observatory in Antarctica, which glimpsed the first high-energy neutrinos from faraway galaxies.

"This experiment in the Antarctic is a revolutionary way of understanding the universe that we didn't have before," said Michael Moloney, chief executive officer for the American Institute of Physics.

When a neutrino interacts with ice in the detector, it produces a flash of light that's picked up by sensors. The transparent ice makes it easier for scientists to pick up on faint signals from the mysterious ghost particles, and the sensors are buried about 8,200 feet (2,500 metres) deep to protect against interference from cosmic rays and radiation.

The 82-year-old scientist is affiliated with the University of Wisconsin-Madison in the US, which operates the observatory. Efforts by The Associated Press to reach him were not immediately successful.

Halzen helped pull the curtain back on a rare gang of neutrinos that scientists say hold clues about the development of the universe.

In a post on social media, Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever said Halzen is the 11th Belgian to win a Nobel Prize. De Wever called the award "impressive recognition for a lifetime dedicated to shedding light on the great mysteries of the cosmos through its smallest components."

A representative from the IceCube Neutrino Observatory did not immediately return a request for comment. The University of Wisconsin-Madison did not immediately comment when reached by the AP.

Ellen Moons, secretary-general of the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences, announced the award Tuesday in Stockholm. She is the first woman to head the prestigious academy and present the award.

The prize money this year is 12 million Swedish kronor (about USD 1.2 million), whether for an individual, a small group of laureates or an organisation.

Last year, three scientists won the Nobel Prize in Physics for research on the strange behaviour of subatomic particles called quantum tunnelling that enabled the ultrasensitive measurements achieved by MRI machines and laid the groundwork for better cellphones and faster computers.

The announcements of this year's prizes began Monday with the Nobel Prize in medicine being awarded to three scientists whose work led to a tool that uses light to help unravel how the brain works.

This week's awards continue Wednesday with the chemistry prize and literature on Thursday.

After Friday's peace prize is awarded, the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences will be announced Monday.

Briefs

Shah likely to visit Manipur in Oct: CM

IMPHAL: Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh on Tuesday said Union Home Minister Amit Shah is likely to visit the northeastern state in October.

Interacting with reporters after a Cabinet meeting, he said that during the discussions, "we resolved to express heartfelt gratitude to PM Modi" for completing 25 years in public service and thanked him for his "special attention, care and developmental focus on Manipur and the northeast".

Jaishankar to undertake 3-nation visit

NEW DELHI: External Affairs minister S Jaishankar on Tuesday embarked on a five-day visit to Ghana, Cote d'Ivoire and Ethiopia to explore ways to shore up bilateral ties in trade and investment and infra development.

Jaishankar's visit is reflective of India's commitment to deepen its partnership with Africa, and will further New Delhi's solidarity with the Global South, the MEA said.

Varanasi: Nabin to address rally

VARANASI: BJP president Nitin Nabin will address a public meeting at Jagatpur Inter College in Rohania on Wednesday to mark the culmination of a motorcycle 'Seva Yatra' from Vadnagar to Varanasi, party officials said.

BJP Kashi region president said a large public meeting has been organised at the Jagatpur Inter College ground, which will be addressed by Nabin.

Dinesh Arya files RS nomination

DEHRADUN: BJP candidate Dinesh Arya, a Scheduled Caste leader from the Kumaon region, on Tuesday filed his nomination for the election to Uttarakhand's lone Rajya Sabha seat, scheduled for October 16.

Arya's nomination is significant as he is a Scheduled Caste leader from the Kumaon region.

AFTER HIS FORCIBLE REMOVAL FROM SIT-IN, DETENTION

Not a single traitor will be spared, says Rahul Gandhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

After his forcible removal from a sit-in protest against "vote chori" at the Akashvani Bhawan and detention, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Friday said there will be accountability and not a single "traitor" would be spared.

"To save the traitors of democracy, the remnants of democracy have been dragged.

"There will be accountability -- not a single traitor will be spared," Gandhi said in a post in Hindi on X, soon after he was detained and taken to the Kingsway Camp police lines.

Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge said Gandhi was peacefully sitting on a dharna, demanding a meeting with the Election Commission (EC) and asserted that registering a peaceful protest is his constitutional right.

"Despite this, forcibly detaining the Leader of the Opposition by the Delhi Police, controlled by Amit Shah, raises serious questions about the Constitution and democratic rights.

"Considerable nervousness is evident in the behaviour of the Prime Minister and the Home minister," Kharge said in a post on X.

"Remember -- in a democracy, the ultimate power lies with the people. The people hold everyone accountable for every action," the Congress president, who had joined the protest march against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in the morning, said.

Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, who was also detained by police along with her brother Rahul Gandhi, told reporters while being taken away by the security personnel, "The nation has never seen a coward government like this.... Is this a way? Staging a protest is our right."

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh also took to X, saying, "Method Of Disenfranchising Indians has just become Murder of Democracy in India."

"The LOP-Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi has been dragged away from a peaceful sit-in protest that had a simple and straightforward demand -- a meeting with the Election Commission of India.

"The Delhi Police that is controlled by the co-conspirator of the Murder of Democracy in India has arrested the LOP-LS and others. This is the sign of a regime that knows its exit is imminent," he said.

Ramesh later attacked the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) for coming out in support of the EC and said, "The public is asking questions of the Election Commission, and the BJP is stepping in as a shield."



Congress MPs Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra at All India Radio after being stopped by security personnel during a protest march, in New Delhi PTI

KEY POINTS

- Kharge said Gandhi was peacefully sitting on a dharna, demanding a meeting with the Election Commission and asserted that registering a peaceful protest is his constitutional right
- The nation has never seen a coward government like this.... Is this a way? Staging a protest is our right, said Priyanka

BJP questions if Congress wants to shield 'fake voters'

Amid intense scrutiny over the 13 crore names struck off draft rolls during the nationwide SIR exercise

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

The BJP on Tuesday rejected the claim of the Congress party that the 13 crore voters had been deleted during the nationwide Special Intensive Revision (SIR), saying the figure cited by the Opposition referred to names removed from the draft electoral rolls and not final deletions.

BJP spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said the Election Commission's data showed that the names included 2.8 crore deceased voters, 6.3 crore people who had shifted, 1 crore duplicate entries and around 3 crore voters who could not be traced.

"I would like to clearly ask the Congress that to whom do they want to benefit by giving voting rights to the absent, shifted, dead and duplicate voters without any investigation? Does the Congress want to benefit someone by doing this," said Trivedi.

TRIVEDI ACCUSED THE CONGRESS OF MISLEADING THE PUBLIC WITH WHAT HE DESCRIBED AS "BASELESS" CLAIMS

BJP leader also accused the Congress of opposing the exercise to protect what he called "fake voters".

Trivedi questioned the Congress' opposition to the voter-roll revision, asking whom the party stood to benefit by allowing "absent, shifted, dead and duplicate voters" to retain voting rights without verification.

He accused the Congress of misleading the public with what he described as "baseless" claims, attributing the party's stance to repeated electoral defeats. Trivedi also accused the Opposition party of having a history of "dynastic rule" and alleged that the party had sought to "strangle democracy" over four generations.

Referring to the Opposition's protest at Akashvani Bhavan, he said Congress had "attempted to infiltrate" the public broadcaster as well.

He also questioned the Congress over its past statements on voter duplication, asking the party to clarify whether it was 'telling the truth then or is doing so now.' Rahul Gandhi himself and many of his senior leaders have said that there is voter duplication at several places.

Akhilesh detained, SP protests in UP

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 6

Samajwadi Party workers staged protests across Uttar Pradesh on Tuesday after party chief Akhilesh Yadav was detained by Delhi Police during an Opposition march demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The protests were reported from several districts, with SP workers raising slogans of "Vote Chor, Istifa Do" and accusing the Election Commission and the BJP govt of undermining democracy. In Gorakhpur, SP workers took to the streets and raised slogans demanding the CEC's resignation. Police tried to stop the protesters at several places as the demonstrations intensified.

In Lucknow, the protest led to a confrontation between SP workers and police. A scuffle broke out as police tried to disperse the demonstrators. Visuals from the protest showed police personnel dragging some SP workers on the road.

In Agra, a confrontation broke out when police allegedly tried to snatch an effigy of the CEC from SP workers. A policeman was seen tripping a protester, causing him to fall to the ground, following which he was allegedly slapped and kicked.

BJP fields 8 candidates, SP 2 for Rajya Sabha polls from Uttar Pradesh

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, October 6

Filing of nomination papers for Rajya Sabha polls ended at 3 pm on Tuesday, with the BJP fielding eight candidates from Uttar Pradesh and the Samajwadi Party two, all of whom are expected to be elected unopposed.

The terms of 10 Rajya Sabha MPs from UP end on November 25, necessitating the elections.

Two independent candidates- Kante Syana, a resident of Tamil Nadu, and Onkar Nath Chaurasia- are also in the fray, but their candidatures will be rejected due to technicalities, the Returning Officer for the Rajya Sabha poll, Ajeet Verma, told news agency. "As of now, 12 candidates are technically in the fray. These include eight from BJP and two from Samajwadi Party. The nominations of 2 independents lack the mandatory signature of 10 lawmakers and would be rejected during scrutiny," Verma said, making it clear that both the BJP and SP candidates are set to be declared elected unopposed.

Tuesday was the last date for filing nominations for the Rajya Sabha polls, followed by scrutiny of papers on October 7. Names can be withdrawn till October 9, while polling (if necessary) will be conducted on October 16.

Earlier on Tuesday, BJP candidates including 3 from OBCs -- UP minister Dharampal Singh (Lodh), OBC wing chief Prakash Pal (Pal), Shruti Gangwar (Kurmi); two from the Dalit community -- Vidya Sagar Sonkar and Priyanka Rawat; two from the Brahmin community -- Radhakant Ojha, Gopi Krishna Pandey and Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan (Thakur) filed their nomination papers.

Police sending notices to CJP activists: Dipke

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 6

Cockroach Janta Party leader Abhijeet Dipke on Tuesday alleged that police in Maharashtra's Chandrapur were sending notices to CJP activists and pressuring them not to attend the October 10 protest in Delhi, and asked why Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis was trying to be "Yogi Adityanath 2.0".

Describing the police's actions as a form of "dictatorship", he said Fadnavis should not "misuse" police for his political ambitions.

Holding a press conference here, Dipke also took swipes at the BJP-led Central govt, saying that 'One Nation, One Election' was merely a slogan and the real objective was "one nation, one political party".

The CJP has announced that it would launch a fresh agitation at Jantar Mantar from October 10 to press for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner.

Abhishek challenges EC to release CCTV footage of counting centres

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, October 6

MAITC national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee on Tuesday challenged Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the Election Commission of India (ECI) to release CCTV footage of the counting process from 100 Assembly constituencies, alleging irregularities in the electoral process.

Speaking during the INDIA Bloc's protest in Delhi demanding Kumar's removal, Banerjee said he could provide a list of 100 constituencies and challenged the Commission to make public five minutes of footage from the nine-hour period of counting at each centre.

"If they are so confident that there was nothing to hide and no wrongdoing, then release the CCTV footage of the counting process. At least 5 minutes of the 9 hours records. Let the evidence speak for itself," Banerjee said.



He specifically referred to constituencies including Bhowanipore, Raina and Satgachia, challenging the ECI to release their counting-centre footage. Banerjee also accused the BJP of being confident of winning elections because it believes Kumar is in a position to help it "steal votes". He said the BJP was unconcerned about unemployment or rising prices of gas, petrol, kerosene and vegetables.

Reacting to BJP leader Sambit Patra's remark that "Lord Ganesh, not Gyanesh, is helping the BJP," Banerjee said, "If someone wants to give Gyanesh Kumar the status of Lord Ganesha, that is a separate matter." He added that the BJP had used the same politics of the Ram Temple but lost in Ayodhya.

"This time they have brought Lord Ganesha into the picture as well, and their defeat in Maharashtra is certain," Banerjee said.

Banerjee further demanded Kumar's resignation and arrest, alleging that the SIR process had curtailed voters' rights. He was later detained by Delhi Police along with several other INDIA Bloc leaders during the march towards the ECI office.

UP launches special drive to add voters left out after SIR

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 6

The Uttar Pradesh election machinery has launched a special drive to identify eligible voters left out of the electoral rolls after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and enrol first-time voters ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections.

Under the drive, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will go door to door to verify the current status of eligible people whose names are missing from the electoral rolls. Those found eligible will be assisted in filing Form 6 for inclusion in the voter list.

The move follows directions issued by the Election Commission of India to the state Chief Electoral Officer's office. The state office has directed all district election officers and other officials to implement the campaign, citing the Commission's October 1, 2026 communication.

As part of the exercise, BLOs will compare the electoral roll published before the SIR, dated January 7, 2025, with the current roll prepared after the revision. They will identify voters whose names appeared in the earlier roll but are missing from the latest list and conduct door-to-door verification.

The campaign will also focus on young people who have become eligible to vote for the first time.

BLOs have been asked to contact at least 20 to 25 such voters every week, with the exercise targeted for completion in about a month.

Form 6 will be filled for eligible voters who were left out, first-time voters and other young people who have not yet been enrolled.

Cabinet lauds PM Modi on 25 years of unbroken leadership

Ministers celebrate the extraordinary journey of Narendra Modi guided by the principles of Nation First and Citizen First

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday passed a resolution congratulating Prime Minister Narendra Modi on completing 25 years of continuous leadership as head of the government.

It celebrated the extraordinary journey of PM Modi guided by the principles of Nation First and Citizen First.

Three overwhelming mandates in Gujarat and support in three successive Lok Sabha polls indicated the support and trust of the public.

The Cabinet dwelt upon ten salient features that capture the unbroken thread connecting his leadership of Gujarat with his leadership of the country.

These include carrying forward his initiatives in Gujarat to the national state, compassion for the poor that translated into delivering homes, potable water, banking and healthcare. Nearly 60 crore Jan Dhan accounts, over four crore homes and moving 25 crore out of poverty showed public action in bringing dignity to the families, the resolution noted.

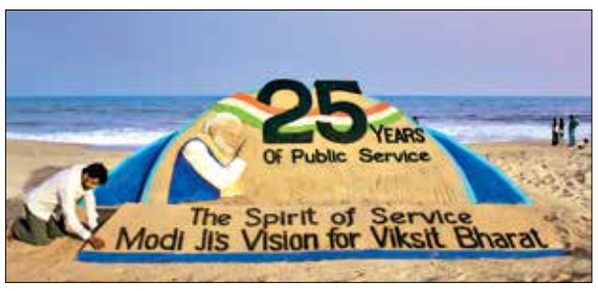
Other areas where PM Modi turned his focus was empowerment of women and farmers through various government schemes and programmes that made around 3.5 crore women LakhpatiDidis, while the Nari Shakti VandanAdhiniyam provided for women's reservation.

The Cabinet's resolution emphasised PM Modi's unwavering commitment to reform despite political risks and it included GST, welfare delivery reforms and the replacement of colonial laws.

Under his leadership, India has increased electronics production from Rs. 2 lakh crore to more than 13 lakh crore and taken up defence production and semiconductor manufacturing. The resolution noted PM Modi's faith in technology that brought improved mobile connectivity, UPI payments and helped in realising the vision of scientifically capable, self-reliant India.

The resolution highlighted his ability to give India direction through global upheaval, particularly during COVID and the West Asia crisis.

It cited 2016 Surgical strikes, 2019 Balakot Air Strikes and 2025 Operation Sindoor as illustrative of the national security red lines established under his leadership.



Sand artist Sudarsan Pattanaik creates a sand sculpture carrying the message of '25 years of Public Service, The Spirit of Service', at Puri Beach, in Puri, Tuesday PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- The Cabinet dwelt upon ten salient features that capture the unbroken thread connecting his leadership of Gujarat with his leadership of the country
- Other areas where PM Modi turned his focus was empowerment of women and farmers

EDITORIAL

Protecting Adult Choices

The Allahabad High Court's assertion that parents cannot use a habeas corpus petition to compel an adult daughter to live with them should have been an unremarkable statement of law. That it still requires judicial reiteration says something uncomfortable about the distance between constitutional adulthood and social adulthood in India. The case involved a 25-year-old woman living independently in Delhi whose mother approached the High Court seeking her production. When the woman appeared, she made it clear that she was living there voluntarily, was not under illegal detention and did not wish to return to her parental home. The court correctly held that once an adult makes a clear and voluntary choice about where and with whom to live, that decision must be respected. Habeas corpus is among the law's strongest protections against unlawful detention; it cannot be converted into an instrument for overriding individual liberty. The principle extends far beyond one family dispute. Indian law recognises adulthood at 18, but social practice frequently attaches qualifications to that freedom, particularly for women. An adult woman may vote, work, own property, enter contracts and make financial decisions, yet her choice of where to live, whom to meet or marry and how to conduct her personal life can still be treated as requiring familial approval.

Parental concern may often arise from genuine anxiety about safety and well-being, but affection does not confer ownership and concern cannot extinguish autonomy. The constitutional promise of personal liberty would mean little if adulthood remained conditional upon parental consent. Indian courts have repeatedly had to protect adults whose personal choices conflict with family expectations, particularly in cases involving relationships and marriage. The frequency with which such disputes reach constitutional courts should itself prompt reflection. Courts should not routinely have to certify that an adult woman possesses freedoms that adulthood is ordinarily assumed to confer. Using habeas corpus to seek the return of an adult who has voluntarily left home risks reversing the very purpose of the remedy: the writ exists to restore liberty, not enforce familial authority. There is also a broader problem with framing women's autonomy primarily through the language of protection, honour and vulnerability. Safety is undoubtedly important, but protection becomes paternalism when it takes away the freedom it claims to safeguard. The answer to unsafe public spaces cannot be to restrict women's presence in them, just as anxiety about relationships cannot justify denying adults control over their lives.

Autonomy does not require families to approve every choice. Parents can advise, disagree, persuade and even strongly disapprove. But there is a fundamental boundary between persuasion and coercion, and the law must remain firmly on the side of voluntary choice. The Allahabad High Court has not weakened the institution of the family; it has merely clarified the constitutional limits of familial authority once a child becomes an adult. Relationships between adult children and parents ultimately have to rest on trust, conversation and mutual respect rather than enforceable control. The larger contradiction deserves attention. India cannot celebrate women entering universities, workplaces, professions and positions of public authority while remaining uncomfortable with the personal independence that gives those achievements meaning. Economic empowerment without personal autonomy is incomplete empowerment. Adulthood cannot be selectively granted, available for responsibilities but withdrawn when individual choices become inconvenient. The freedom to decide where to live and whom to live with is neither an indulgence nor an act of rebellion against the family. It is among the most elementary expressions of individual liberty. A society confident about women's advancement must learn to accept not merely their success, but their choices.

LETTER

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Price Turbulence

IndiGo's second fuel surcharge hike since April underlines how volatile jet fuel prices are making air travel increasingly expensive. While airlines cannot ignore rising operating costs, repeated fare increases risk putting flights beyond the reach of many travellers. Greater efficiency and competitive pricing must accompany unavoidable cost adjustments.

KRISHNA SARKAR,
KOLKATA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Modi and the New Global Symmetry

PM Modi's push for reformed institutions and equitable partnerships has increasingly echoed through the evolving Global South discourse

GLOBAL REBALANCE



ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS MEMBER NEC, BJP & CHAIRMAN, DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION



Modi is not proposing a contest but a roadmap for a more inclusive order

As Prime Minister Narendra Modi completes 25 years in public office and, in that, 12 years as Prime Minister of India, his vision for a new and reformed global order has clearly generated debate across the world. Modi has emerged as the philosopher and shaper of the Global South narrative.

Modi's governance philosophy and method have repeatedly attracted global attention, and his solution-oriented approach has received international endorsement.

When President Subianto of Indonesia spoke of replicating Modi's governance models successfully in Indonesia, it indicated the impact Modi's methods were having globally, especially in countries with which we have a civilisational likeness.

Nearly a decade ago, veteran Singaporean diplomat and public intellectual Kishore Mahbubani had spoken of Modi's conviction that good governance could transform and uplift society. That recognition has spread in the intervening years, making Modi one of the most consistent upholders of global good through good governance.

Modi's approach has been to prod the Global South to partner and collaborate in evolving best practices in governance. This was reflected in BRICS Delhi, when Modi spoke of "Capacity Building for Developing Nations."

Recognition for Modi is not limited to his governance. In international diplomacy, to the chagrin of Modi's domestic and international detractors, he is being recognised as a solution seeker, a voice of stability and an advocate for the narrative of shared prosperity.

President Putin's remarks at the latest edition of the Valdai Discussion Club, candidly appreciating PM Modi's strong intent in finding a peaceful and mutually acceptable solution to the Ukraine-Russia conflict, are one of the finest and most direct recognitions of Modi's international standing.

Modi's call for reformed international institutions is increasingly finding takers. His call to dismantle the *"Pyramid of Privilege"* in global institutions and alter it to an inclusive *"Platform of Partnership"* reiterates that. Modi does not speak of a triangular contest between a Global West, Global East and Global South. He is driven by a legitimate quest for equity in global governance and decision-making.

INDIA HAS INCREASINGLY POSITIONED ITSELF AT THE CENTRE OF THE DEBATE OVER A REBALANCED GLOBAL ORDER

In his *Foreign Affairs* essay, *"The West's Last Chance: How to Build a New Global Order Before It's Too Late"*, Finnish President Alexander Stubb argues that the Global South will play a defining role in deciding "whether geopolitics in the next era leans towards cooperation, fragmentation or domination." Stubb argues that this is the last chance for Western countries to convince the rest of the world that they are capable of dialogue rather than monologue, consistency rather than double standards, and cooperation rather than domination.

International institutions, Stubb says, "need to be updated and reformed to better reflect the growing economic and political power of the Global South and Global East." He insists that Western leaders must now act to get it done, and it has to start by "rebalancing the power within the UN" and other international bodies such as the IMF, WTO and the WB.

Without such changes, Stubb sees the existing multilateral system "crumble." He speaks of a "new symmetry of power among the Global West, East, South" that would "produce a rebalanced world order in which countries could deal with the most pressing global challenges through cooperation and dialogue among equals." Stubb's position reflects and echoes Modi's aspirations for the Global South.

Kishore Mahbubani, in his essay *"The Dream Palace of the West: Why the Old Order is Gone for Good"*, in the same journal, starkly endorses the Global South. "Engaging with the Global South," writes Mahbubani, "is not just an exercise in listening. It also requires Western governments to reassess their own positions and approaches to a world they have long taken for granted." Mahbubani calls for reformed multilateral institutions "to accommodate rising powers, especially India and China" and calls for an enlarged UNSC with India, among others, as a permanent member.

Mahbubani calls for dialogue among equals. "A good dialogue," he argues, "requires good listening. Unfortunately, the 12 per cent of the world's population that lives in the West hasn't yet learned the art of listening to the remaining 88 per cent with whom they share the planet." When Modi calls for dismantling the *"Pyramid of Privilege"* and creating an inclusive *"Platform of Partnership"*, he is essentially asking that 12 per cent to listen, to have a good dialogue and to evolve a partnership of equals with the remaining 88 per cent.

Modi is not proposing a contest. He is delineating, instead, a roadmap, an alternative order that is more inclusive and responsive. Unlike his predecessors from the past, PM Modi does not want to keep India out of this debate. He wants India to be an active stakeholder and shaper of the new order. He wants India to help rebalance and establish a new symmetry. In the last 12 years, he has forced an increasingly dynamic and multidimensional global debate on the future of the world.

Views expressed are personal

After the Headlines Fade

Protecting women cannot mean restricting their freedom while the real dangers remain untouched

BROKEN JUSTICE



GARIMA JAIN

THE WRITER TEACHES AT O.P. JINDAL GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

By every measure the state uses, the response to the gang rape of a seventeen-year-old in Aastha Kunj on 21 September has been a success. Three arrests within a day. One accused shot in the leg. A safety audit of every park in Delhi, entry restricted after sunset.

I spent eight years studying rape for my doctoral research, and by the measure victimology uses, the girl herself disappeared from this story on 22 September. Nothing that has happened since is about her. I can tell you what happens next because I watched it happen to everyone before her.

Early in my fieldwork, I went to meet a family whose eight-year-old had been raped by her stepfather. The man who opened the door was the stepfather. A colleague who had worked on these cases for years advised me: wear a suit and a bindi, look married, and, if possible, wear sindoor.

I have never stopped thinking about what it meant that the way to be safe while studying rape in this country was to look like I belonged to a man. That is the logic of our response to sexual violence. Protection is offered to women in exchange for being less present: less visible, less free, less in the park after dark. Lock the gates. Move the classes online. Wear the sindoor.

Victimology has a term for the kind of victim a society finds easiest to believe: the ideal victim. She is a woman attacked by a stranger while doing something respectable. The girl in Aastha Kunj is close to that ideal: a child, on her way to the Kalkaji temple, attacked by strangers pretending to be police. But watch as the case ages. She was in a park at 7.30 in the evening with a male friend. When the story becomes about her choices, the anger will fade and the questions will begin: why was she there, why so late, who was the boy.

A sixteen-year-old in Swaroop Nagar, gang-raped and murdered earlier this month, drew a fraction of the attention: she had left school and gone to meet a boy she knew. Sympathy for a rape victim is rationed by honour: by whether the girl was where a good girl is supposed to be.



Protection is offered to women in exchange for being less present

THE SURVIVOR'S STRUGGLE OFTEN BEGINS AFTER PUBLIC OUTRAGE FADES AND ARRESTS ARE MADE

But here is what my research found that I did not expect. Even the most ideal victim is not protected from what the system does next. The December 2012 Delhi gang rape produced the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013, which the country still calls the Nirbhaya Act. Her mother, Asha Devi, told me that the family never knew what was happening in the case. She had to hire a private lawyer to attend hearings, while the convicts stretched the process across seven years. The mother the laws were written for described the system as something that happened to her, not for her.

She is not the exception. The father of a nine-year-old boy waited ten years for compensation and said the sentence that sums up my entire dissertation: we are invisible in this process of justice. A girl a court advised to marry the man who assaulted her said: he did what he did to me, not to the court. In India, it is not a malfunction. It is the design. The system turns a person into a case file, her trauma into evidence, and her need to heal into a wait for a verdict that, when it comes, ends in acquittal three times out of four.

And when it fails, we reach for the only tool we have. After 2012, we widened the definition of rape, built fast-track courts and brought in the death penalty for child rape. Our response to rape is a failure of imagination. We cannot picture justice as anything other than punishment or restriction. The victims I listened to could imagine more. Asha Devi wanted the hanging, but also remorse, information, prevention and to be treated as a person in her daughter's case. The families I sat with wanted safety, dignity, a voice, and enough money to keep their other children in school. The state offers punishment and compensation, delivering the first a quarter of the time and the second, as the father of that nine-year-old learned, a decade late.

A victim-centred system would not require a new law. It requires one named victim advocate for every survivor, standing with her and her family from FIR to verdict. Not a helpline. A person who calls before and after every hearing. The POCSO Rules of 2020 already entitle every child victim to a support person, and in 2023 the Supreme Court held that providing one is the state's obligation, not an option. Enforce it, and extend it to every rape survivor, adult or child. It costs almost nothing.

The audit due this week will tell us how many lights and cameras Delhi's parks have. It will not tell us whether a woman can be in one at nine at night, or what happens to a seventeen-year-old after the arrests are made. Those are the only two questions that matter.

Views expressed are personal

When Power Outruns Judgement

Ashwatthama's tragic choices reveal why extraordinary capability must be matched by judgement, restraint, self-awareness and the discipline to stop in time

BHARAT KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

A battle can end before a warrior accepts that it is over. Sometimes, the greatest danger begins precisely at that moment.

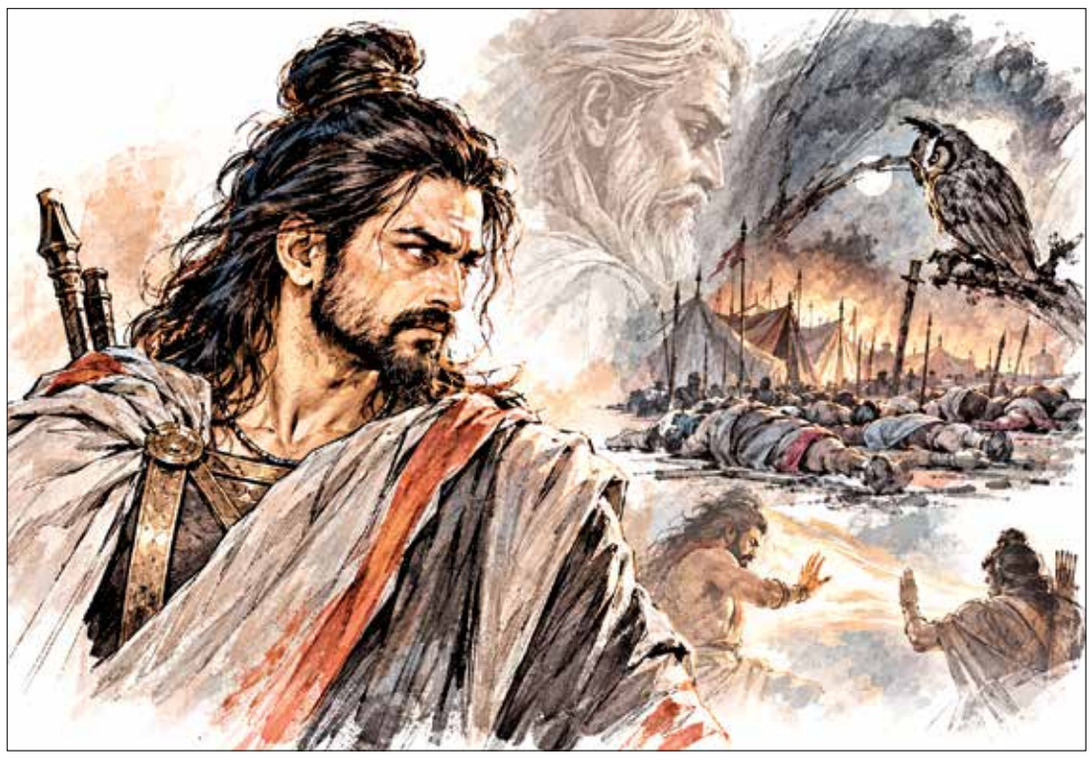
By the closing stages of the Kurukshetra war, the Kaurava cause had effectively collapsed. Duryodhana lay mortally wounded, Drona had fallen, and the field that had once carried armies was filled with loss. For Ashwatthama, however, defeat did not bring reflection. It brought a determination to retaliate. His story therefore raises a question that extends far beyond the battlefield: what happens when a person of immense ability allows grief, loyalty and humiliation to overpower judgement?

Yet Ashwatthama's story did not begin with power. As a child, he grew up in poverty. The Mahabharata recounts how, after seeing wealthier children drink milk, he was once given water mixed with powdered rice and believed that he too had tasted milk. The episode is remembered largely because of what it stirred in Drona, who was pained by his inability to provide for his son. It would be simplistic to draw a straight line from childhood deprivation to Ashwatthama's later choices, but the contrast is striking. The boy who once lacked even milk would grow into a warrior entrusted with some of the most destructive knowledge of his age.

Ashwatthama was no ordinary warrior. The son of Dronacharya, he received exceptional martial training and grew up alongside princes who would shape the future of the Kuru kingdom. His ability was never the problem. What makes his story especially relevant to leadership is the question of whether ability and readiness are always the same thing. Drona himself appears to have recognised the difference. After giving Arjuna knowledge of the Brahmashira, Ashwatthama pressed his father for the same weapon. Drona eventually taught him, but reluctantly, and warned him never to use it against human beings even in extreme danger. The greater the capability entrusted to an individual, the greater the need for judgement, self-command and ethical discipline.

The warning is important because authority is rarely given without expectations about how it will be used. In an organisation, access to confidential information, financial discretion, institutional influence or decision-making power is not personal property. It is entrusted for a purpose. Being capable of exercising power does not mean one is prepared to exercise it wisely, and being granted authority does not remove the limits attached to it.

Ashwatthama's hunger for exceptional power appears again in an extraordinary episode involving Krishna. He sought Krishna's Sudarshana Chakra and was permitted to try to take it, but could not move it. When Krishna asked why he wanted the weapon, Ashwatthama revealed that he had hoped eventually to challenge Krishna and become invincible. The episode reveals ambition not simply as the desire to excel, but as the desire to possess the symbols and instruments of supremacy. Ambition becomes dangerous when the desire for authority grows faster than the maturity required to exercise it. Leadership cannot be acquired merely by possessing the title, tool or privilege associated with it.



The ability to act does not by itself create the right to act

His bond with Drona nevertheless remained central to his identity. When Drona was killed after being led to believe that Ashwatthama had died, the loss was devastating. Ashwatthama's grief was real, as was his fury at the manner of his father's death. Any reading of his later actions must recognise that emotional wound. Understanding the source of an emotion is not the same as legitimising every action taken under its influence. Pain may explain a decision. It does not automatically justify it.

That distinction matters in organisational life. People carry disappointment, loyalty, pride, memories of unfairness and sometimes the grievances of those they respect. Ashwatthama increasingly allowed loyalty to his father and anger over his death to define the boundaries of what he considered permissible. Responsible loyalty cannot mean surrendering one's conscience. Leaders must be able to honour mentors, colleagues and institutions without inheriting every grievance as their own moral compass.

INTELLIGENCE DOES NOT GUARANTEE WISDOM, AND STRATEGIC BRILLIANCE DOES NOT MAKE THE OBJECTIVE ETHICAL

After Duryodhana's defeat, Ashwatthama, Kripa and Kritavarma withdrew to a forest and rested beneath a banyan tree. Kripa and Kritavarma slept, but Ashwatthama, consumed by rage, remained awake. There he saw an owl descend upon sleeping crows and kill them while they were defenceless. Rather than recoil from the image, he recognised in it a strategy. He resolved to attack the enemy camp at night.

This episode reveals something more disturbing than simple anger. Ashwatthama was still thinking strategically. His intelligence had not disappeared. It had become subordinate to vengeance. Intelligence does not guarantee wisdom, and strategic brilliance does not make the objective itself ethical. Organisations can become highly efficient at pursuing a course of action that should never have been chosen in the first place. Leaders must therefore ask not only, "How can this be done?" but also, "Should this be done at all?"

Even then, Ashwatthama was not without counsel. Kripa urged deliberation and warned against acting under the sway of anger, arguing for restraint and proper judgement. Ashwatthama heard him, but his decision had effectively already been made. The presence of good advisers means little when a leader seeks validation rather than counsel. Healthy leadership requires more than surrounding oneself with experienced people. It requires retaining the capacity to be changed by what they say.

Ashwatthama then entered the Pandava camp at night and killed Dhrishtadyumna, Shikhandi, Draupadi's sons and many others while the camp was largely asleep and unprepared. In that moment, vengeance overcame the boundaries that ought to have governed even conflict. Ethical standards are easiest to defend when they cost little. Their real value appears when anger, competition or perceived injustice creates a convincing reason to abandon them.

Ashwatthama could point to wrongs committed during the war, including the circumstances of his father's death. But values cannot depend entirely on the conduct of the other side. If every breach authorises another breach, ethics becomes a temporary convenience rather than a governing principle. Responsible leadership interrupts that cycle. It does not require passivity in the face of wrongdoing, but it insists that accountability remain proportionate, principled and directed towards the actual wrong.

His night attack also shows how easily grievance can widen its circle of guilt. His anger arose from particular losses, yet its consequences spread to people who were not responsible for all that he had suffered. Once collective association becomes a substitute for individual responsibility, judgement gives way to punishment by proximity. In institutions, the same failure appears when conflict with one individual becomes suspicion of an entire team, or when a successor dismantles sound work simply because it belonged to a predecessor they resented. Disciplined fairness requires leaders to distinguish accountability from vengeance.

The final confrontation with Arjuna brings Ashwatthama's story full circle. Pursued after the massacre, he invoked the Brahmashira, the very weapon his father had reluctantly entrusted to him and explicitly warned him not to use against human beings. Arjuna invoked the same weapon in response. When Vyasa and Narada intervened and warned of catastrophic consequences, Arjuna withdrew his weapon. Ashwatthama could not withdraw his and ultimately redirected its force towards Uttara's womb, seeking to destroy the unborn continuation of the Pandava line.

The contrast is powerful because both men possessed extraordinary capability. What separated them in that moment was not what they could unleash, but what they could control. The ability to act does not by itself create the right to act. Power entrusted without self-command can become a danger not only to opponents, but to the very values and legacy it was meant to defend.

The episode also warns against irreversible decisions. A public accusation cannot always be erased. Confidential information once disclosed cannot be made private again. Trust broken in anger may not return because an apology follows. Emotional discipline is therefore not merely a personal virtue. It is an organisational safeguard. The more consequential the decision, the more important the capacity to create distance between impulse and action.

Ashwatthama's story is ultimately also about the ethics of losing. By the time of the night attack, the Kaurava cause was effectively lost. Yet he could not allow defeat to end the conflict within himself. Defeat does not cancel responsibility. A leader passed over for a position, a team whose proposal fails, or a senior figure whose authority has ended still retains obligations towards the institution. Dignity in defeat lies in refusing to turn personal disappointment into institutional damage.

Ashwatthama remains one of the Mahabharata's most unsettling figures because he was neither powerless nor incapable. He possessed training, courage, lineage, intelligence and access to extraordinary weapons. He was warned. He was counselled. He had opportunities to reconsider. Yet again and again, the desire to act outran the discipline to stop.

That is why his story continues to matter. Institutions do not become responsible merely by placing talented people in positions of influence. They become stronger when capability is accompanied by judgement, ambition by self-awareness, loyalty by conscience, accountability by fairness and authority by self-command. The true test of leadership is not whether we possess power, but whether we remain capable of governing ourselves when emotion gives us a reason to misuse it.

The true measure of power is not how far we can go, but whether we know when to stop.

Views expressed are personal

Urban India is Heading Towards Gridlock

***Indian cities need better public transport, safer walking and less dependence on private vehicles; writes* Sunita Narain**

Indian cities are increasingly trapped in congestion that wastes time, worsens air pollution and damages quality of life. Travel times routinely rise sharply during peak hours, while vehicles crawling through traffic burn fuel inefficiently and increase exposure to harmful pollutants. The problem is no longer confined to India's biggest metros; smaller and million-plus cities are following the same trajectory.

An analysis of mobility patterns across more than 40 cities by Down To Earth reveals a striking contradiction. Walking and cycling remain fundamental to urban mobility, with nearly half the population in several major cities depending on these modes. Non-motorised transport accounts for 42 per cent of commuting in Delhi, 47 per cent in Mumbai and 48 per cent in Kolkata. In cities such as Varanasi, Singrauli and Visakhapatnam, its share exceeds 50 per cent. Yet most urban roads remain poorly designed for pedestrians and cyclists.

At the same time, private vehicles are multiplying rapidly. India registered 25.5 million vehicles in 2024-25, more than 88 per cent of them for personal mobility. Two-wheelers dominate private motorised travel in several large cities, while car dependence is rising even in smaller towns. Gangtok, for instance, records 54 per cent of trips by car. Such dependence often reflects inadequate, expensive or poorly connected public transport rather than simply growing prosperity.

PUBLIC TRANSPORT HAS FAILED TO KEEP PACE WITH THE CHANGING GEOGRAPHY OF INDIA'S EXPANDING CITIES

Public transport has struggled to keep pace. Mega and metro cities have recorded a decline in the share of bus trips, while investment in metro systems has produced only a modest shift in overall mobility. Where formal systems are weak, shared autos, e-rickshaws and informal minibuses increasingly fill the gap. They provide essential last-mile connectivity but, without integration into wider transport networks, can also add to congestion and safety problems.

Urban expansion is compounding the crisis. In mega and metro cities, people are making more trips and travelling farther than they did 15 to 20 years ago. Delhi's average trip length has increased from around 6 km to nearly 11 km. Longer distances between homes, workplaces and essential services encourage greater dependence on private vehicles.

Building more roads is unlikely to solve the problem. Delhi already devotes around 23 per cent of its land to roads, yet remains heavily congested. Instead, cities need reliable buses, integrated public transport, better last-mile connectivity and safe infrastructure for walking and cycling. Urban planning must also bring homes, employment and services closer together.

Vehicle use must be managed through parking controls, congestion pricing and policies that reflect the true costs of private mobility. Better mobility data is equally essential because many cities still rely on outdated information. India's urban transport crisis ultimately requires a change in priorities: cities must be planned around people rather than cars.

PROCUREMENT OF INDIGENOUS FCS & LAUNCHERS

Navy's BrahMos strike capability set for boost with Rs 661.50-crore deal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

The Ministry of Defence, on Tuesday, inked a Rs 661.50-crore deal with BrahMos Aerospace Private Limited (BAPL) for procurement of BrahMos Fire Control System (FCS) and Launchers for warships of the Indian Navy, enhancing the striking capability of the maritime arm while providing a big boost towards the domestic production of state-of-the-art missile systems of the country.

The agreement, signed in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, comes under the Buy (Indian-IDDM) category and has a minimum domestic content of 68 per cent. It is expected to create employment in a period of three years and will involve the participation of Indian industry, including micro, small and medium enterprises.

The agreement is important in the sense that it includes the ship platform architecture necessary for employing the BrahMos missile system and not just the missiles themselves. The Fire Control System acts as the command and fire control component that interfaces with the warship's Combat Management, Navigation and Sensor Systems for target selection and generation of the parameters for the engagement of the missile. The launchers form the platform and electrical interface for launching BrahMos missiles from the warship.



Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh and others after signing an agreement with BAPL

HIGHLIGHTS

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The BrahMos SSM suite installed on various frontline warships is the main SSM suite of the Indian Navy for maritime strike operations. A supersonic weapon capable of striking land and sea targets at long ranges, the weapon provides the front-line warships of the Indian Navy with the capability of conducting standoff attacks with high precision.

This contract will further bolster the capability of the Indian Navy to employ the BrahMos weapon system onboard their warships as the Indian Navy looks to increase its maritime combat capabilities. This contract also indicates that more importance is being given to the development of an indigenous ecosystem of weapon systems that include launch and fire control systems.

The contract has added significance given the rising importance of maritime security for India and the requirement of maintaining credible long-range strike capabilities in the Indian Ocean region. The Fire Control Systems and launchers are acquired under the Indian-IDDM classification by the Government of India to build domestic capacity in advanced missile systems.

In the opinion of the Ministry of Defence, this project is yet another important step taken by the Indian Armed Forces in their endeavour to indigenize high-end military technologies and bolster the defence industry base of India. As Indian firms and MSMEs are part of this project, it will result in a greater industrial ecosystem surrounding naval weapon systems.

BrahMos Aerospace, which is a joint venture between India and Russia, has become an integral part of India's capability for precision strike. The aim behind the induction and integration of this system in frontline warships is to boost the capability of the Navy to launch rapid and precise strikes against threats both at sea and ashore.

This latest contract does not end at the procurement of the weapon systems alone; it signifies the overall move towards a network-centric approach of maritime strikes.

Govt notifies 375 permissible works under VB-G RAM G Act

'This expands list of works by 41% over the previous scheme'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 6

The Centre has notified 375 permissible works under the new rural employment framework, with a greater emphasis on livelihood infrastructure, water security and disaster preparedness, expanding the list of works by 41 per cent over the previous scheme.

The Ministry of Rural Development said the new schedule, under the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (VB-G RAM G) Gramin Act, 2025, divides the works into four categories -- water security, core rural infrastructure, livelihood-related infrastructure, and special works for extreme weather events and disaster preparedness.

Of the 375 works, 128 fall under water security, 111 under core rural infrastructure, 98 under livelihood-related infrastructure and 38 under disaster preparedness, according to the ministry.

'LIVELIHOOD-RELATED WORKS WOULD ACCOUNT FOR 26% OF THE TOTAL'

The expanded list includes water conservation and irrigation structures, rural health and community facilities, agro-processing units, cold storage infrastructure and flood protection works.

The ministry said livelihood-related works would account for 26 per cent of the total, compared with 1.1 per cent under the previous framework.

These include cleaning, grading and packaging units, mini flour mills, market yards, dairy infrastructure, mushroom cultivation sheds and aquaculture structures.

Infrastructure for self-help groups and their federations, including SHG worksheds and SHE Marts, as well as training and skill development centres, has also been included.

Water security remains the largest category, covering check dams, recharge shafts, rejuvenation of rivers and water channels, reclamation of waterlogged land and rainwater harvesting.

The schedule also provides for drip irrigation, sprinkler systems and interventions such as artificial glaciers for water conservation.

VACB probe against CEC Kumar linked to Keralam road project

MPOST BUREAU
Thiruvananthapuram, October 6

The Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) inquiry ordered by Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar is linked to a World Bank-funded road-upgrade project dating back to his tenure as state Public Works Department (PWD) secretary.

Kumar, a 1988-batch IAS officer of the Keralam cadre, headed the PWD when the Keralam State Transport Project (KSTP) was awarded and implemented. Allegations concerning the project first surfaced in 2006, leading to a preliminary VACB inquiry. The latest probe will continue the investigation into those allegations.

Chennithala said the inquiry was ordered on October 4 after obtaining legal advice and consulting Chief Minister VD Satheesan.

The complaint was filed by a Congress leader, while the Congress-led state government ordered the inquiry amid Opposition demands for Kumar's removal as CEC over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Opposition parties have criticised the SIR exercise, alleging that the voter-list revision could disenfranchise voters. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi had on September 24 sought Kumar's resignation, citing "objections raised by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi".

Briefs

Minor girl raped in Kota

KOTA: A minor girl was allegedly kidnapped and raped by a 19-year-old man in a village here, police said. The accused was detained. The survivor, who suffered heavy bleeding, was admitted to New Medical College Hospital and is stable. A case was registered under BNS and POCSO provisions.

Mumbai cops raid bogus clinics

MUMBAI: Mumbai Police Crime Branch raided several clinics allegedly run by bogus doctors and seized syringes, antibiotic tablets and other equipment worth Rs 2.20 lakh, an official said. Ten people were booked under the Maharashtra Medical Practitioners Act. The raids covered Bhandup, Mankhurd, Kurla, Jogeshwari, Borivali and Dahisar. Further investigation is underway.

UP: 5 held with Rs 2-cr smack

BAHRAICH: Police arrested five people and seized 429 grams of smack worth around Rs 2 crore in the international market during three operations in Bahraich, officials said. The accused included a woman from Barabanki. Police also recovered vehicles, mobile phones, cash and documents. Cases under the NDPS Act were registered.

CJI administers oath to three new judges

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 6

Chief Justice Surya Kant on Tuesday administered oath of office to three new judges elevated to the Supreme Court, taking its working strength to 37, one short of the sanctioned 38.

Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Aparesh Kumar Singh took oath in the auditorium of the new Supreme Court block.

All the Supreme Court judges, judicial officers and officials from different high courts were present on the occasion.

Family members and lawyers from the Supreme Court and other high courts were also present during the ceremony.

On Monday, Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal made the announcement about the government clearing the names of the three judges.

The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended the names on September 28.

While the current working strength of the apex court is 34 and upon swearing in of the three new judges, the effective strength has gone up to 37.

The top court's sanctioned strength is 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India. It was recently increased from 34 following the Supreme Court Amendment Act, 2026.

With Justice Sunita Agarwal's appointment, the number of women judges in the top court has gone up to three, including Justice B V Nagarathna, who has been a judge in the top court since August 31, 2021, and Justice Venkita Subramani Mohana, who was appointed on June 2, 2026.

While Justice Agarwal and Justice Nagarathna have a background of serving in high courts, Justice Mohana was elevated directly from the Bar. She had been a senior advocate of the Supreme Court.

ED summons Punjab CM's brother-in-law

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has summoned Amardeep Singh Grewal, brother-in-law of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, for questioning in connection with its probe into an alleged bribery case involving the CM's wife.

Grewal, a Punjabi film personality associated with East Sunshine Production Pvt Ltd, has been asked to appear before the agency as part of its investigation into the alleged money trail.

He has been associated with Punjabi films, including Maujaan Hi Maujaan (2023) and Snowman (2022), which have overseas production or release linkages.

The ED is examining the financial and other connections of people allegedly linked to the case, including Grewal's business interests.

Hry CM, Singapore FM discuss ties in key development sectors

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 6



CM Nayab Saini signs MoUs worth Rs 5,500-cr with Singaporean companies. Minister Rao Narbir Singh also seen in picture

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday met Singapore Foreign Minister Vivian Balakrishnan and discussed ways to deepen cooperation between Haryana and Singapore in education, skill development, water management, urban development, technological innovation and employment generation.

Saini thanked the Singapore government for its hospitality and said Haryana could benefit from Singapore's experience in modern urban planning, water management and technology-driven development.

He said Haryana was adapting its development model to the changing economic environment and emerging technologies. Greater cooperation with Singapore, he added, could help the state adopt modern solutions for water treatment, conservation and urban planning.

Saini said a stronger partnership between Haryana and Singapore could provide fresh momentum to the state's development efforts.

Balakrishnan welcomed Saini and said Singapore remained committed to strengthening its cooperation with India and Haryana. He particularly assured support in connecting Haryana's youth with skill development programmes and creating employment opportunities for them at the global level.

The two sides agreed to expand cooperation in education and skills, develop modern training programmes and employment opportunities for young people, and promote advanced technologies in water management and urban development.

Saini said Haryana's young workforce, combined with Singapore's technological expertise, could create new opportunities for the state's growth.

Guj: 7 killed as SUV crashes into truck

MPOST BUREAU
Bhavnagar, October 6

Seven persons were killed after their SUV rammed into a parked trailer truck on a highway in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district on Tuesday, police said.

The victims were travelling from Bhavnagar to Alang, where they worked at a shipyard, Superintendent of Police Nitesh Pandey said.

The accident occurred on the service road along the Bhavnagar-Somnath national highway near Trapaj village in Talaja taluka of the district at around 10 am when the speeding Sports Utility Vehicle (SUV) crashed into the stationary trailer, according to police.

"The trailer was parked on the service road of the highway near Trapaj village, within the jurisdiction of the Alang police station. A Bolero approaching from behind crashed into the rear of the trailer. Six persons died at the scene, and one person succumbed during treatment," Pandey said.

The impact of the collision was so severe that the trailer was pushed forward, and bodies were found scattered along the highway, with the SUV completely wrecked in the accident, eyewitnesses said.

The SUV's doors had to be forced open using iron bars to pull out the victims.

After being alerted, police and ambulance service reached the spot. The bodies were transported to a government hospital in Bhavnagar for postmortem.

An investigation was underway into the incident, the police added.

'Year of Youth': MP to hold 2 public service exams in 2027

CM Mohan Yadav announces a slew of schemes for youngsters at Youth Conclave-2026

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, October 6



KEY POINTS

- 12 medical colleges, 12 new universities and skill training for 1 lakh youths announced
- Rs 5-cr 'Idea Fund', AI labs and free competitive-exam coaching planned across the state

Madhya Pradesh will observe 2027 as the 'Year of Youth', with the state government announcing a series of initiatives focused on education, skill development, employment, research and entrepreneurship, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav said at the CM Youth Conclave-2026 here on Tuesday.

Addressing the conclave, Yadav announced that the Madhya Pradesh Public Service Commission (MPPSC) would conduct two examinations in 2027 instead of one. The government will also establish 12 new medical colleges and 12 universities offering employment-oriented courses, while one lakh youths will be covered under skill-development programmes.

A dedicated portal for the Year of Youth will be launched to invite ideas and suggestions from young people, with the government considering suitable proposals for implementation. Free coaching for competitive examinations will also be provided in government colleges across all districts.

The Chief Minister further announced that a special agency would be engaged to improve campus placements and connect students with employment opportunities. Postgraduate female students will also be brought under the ambit of the Gaon Ki Beti and Pratibha Kiran schemes.

All government colleges will get advanced Artificial Intelligence and advanced computing laboratories, while monthly assistance for research scholars in higher education will be increased from Rs 16,000 to Rs 25,000. A Rs 5-crore state-level 'Idea Fund' will be created to encourage youth start-up ideas. Emphasising technology and innovation, Yadav said the state was emerging beyond its traditional agriculture-based identity, with progress in industry, IT, medical education and innovation. He said 85,000 youths had been provided government jobs across departments and stressed the government's aim of making young people job creators rather than job seekers.

The Chief Minister also announced 500 new National Service Scheme units and hostels for working women in every division. He said the Global Investors Summit would again be organised in 2027, creating additional employment opportunities. During an interaction with students, Yadav highlighted initiatives in agriculture, AI, start-ups and sports. He said Bhopal is developing AI and Knowledge City, while a Science City is coming up in Ujjain. Sports, he added, would receive special priority during the Year of Youth.

News at a glance

Spain okays 21 urgent housing measures after protests

MADRID: Spain's government on Tuesday approved urgent measures to tackle the housing crisis, after an outbreak of violence the night before in Barcelona saw tens of thousands taking to the streets demanding a quick resolution.

The angry protests followed nationwide demonstrations over the weekend. All were triggered by the eviction of 87-year-old Maria del Carmen Abascal from her Madrid home last month. The approved steps were similar to those Parliament rejected last week.

PM Sharif invites Imran's party for talks amid march

ISLAMABAD: PM Shehbaz Sharif on Tuesday invited the opposition Pakistan Tehreek-i-Insaf for talks to resolve contentious issues through dialogue, as he urged the party founded by jailed former premier Imran Khan to call off its long march to Islamabad.

Sharif issued the call for talks two days after the PTI launched its long march from Lakki Marwat town of Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa with intention to make it to national capital in coming days to give a sit-in to press the government to set Khan free.

Germany arrests ex-foreign intelligence chief over spying

BERLIN: Germany's federal prosecutor's office said a former foreign intelligence chief was arrested Tuesday on espionage allegations.

August Hanning, 80, served as president of the Federal Intelligence Service, or BND, from December 1998 to November 2005.

He is "strongly suspected of treasonous espionage, spying out state secrets, attempted treason, and espionage," the federal prosecutor's office said in a statement. Hanning was arrested in Bad Toelz-Wolfratshausen in southern Germany.



Demonstrators march at a protest opposing 'Operation Midway Blitz' and the presence of ICE in Chicago AP/PTI

Briefs

Pak: Hindu temple vandalised

KARACHI: A man has been arrested on suspicion of vandalising a Hindu temple in Rathi village in the Nagarparkar area of Pakistan's southern Sindh province, police said on Tuesday.

The man was taken into custody after parts of the Mata Jog Maya Temple were found vandalised on Monday night, a local police officer said.

"When the caretaker woke up this morning, he found some of the murtis (idols) smashed and broken and reported the matter to the police," said Shiva Kaachi, chairman of the Pakistan Darawar Ittehad NGO.

SL: Namal's remand extended

COLOMBO: A Sri Lankan court on Tuesday extended until October 16 the remand of lawmaker Namal Rajapaksa, the eldest son of former president Mahinda Rajapaksa, and former Executive Director of Krrish Group Janaki Siriwardena.

Namal, who is already in remand custody, was produced before the Colombo Chief Magistrate's Court, which issued the order.

The Commission to Investigate Allegations of Bribery or Corruption has filed the case against Namal and Siriwardena on a bribery accusation of 70 million Sri Lankan rupees in connection with a stalled hotel project.

Kenya confirms 1st Ebola case

NAIROBI: Kenya's Health Ministry on Tuesday confirmed the country's first imported Ebola case from Congo.

Health Minister Aden Duale said a Kenyan citizen who arrived in the country on Saturday from Congo via Uganda had been isolated and treated at Nairobi Hospital.

The patient tested positive for the Ebola virus after developing symptoms associated with hemorrhagic fever.

The patient died on late Monday while receiving treatment of the virus.

FLYDUBAI FLIGHT ATTACK

'Revenge for Gaza': Omani co-pilot reveals motive

AGENCIES
Washington, October 6

Hamam al-Hammami, the Omani co-pilot who brutally attacked the captain of a flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv and then tried to crash the airliner last week, wanted "revenge for Gaza", a television news broadcaster in Israel has reported quoting investigators.

Currently detained and undergoing interrogation within the United Arab Emirates, al-Hammami informed investigators that his plan involved operating the flight in a routine manner after incapacitating the captain, securing all mandatory landing clearances, and subsequently crashing into an airport facility or stationed aircraft, as detailed by Hebrew media sources cited by The Times of Israel.

According to The Times of Israel, that consideration accounted for why al-Hammami delayed seizing control of the flight deck until the aeroplane traversed Jordanian airspace.

His actions were thwarted when Captain Smit Machchhar, an Indian, despite suffering an assault and stab wounds from al-Hammami, succeeded in unlatching the cockpit portal, allowing a group of Israeli travellers to grapple with and restrain the attacker, while an individual among them steadied the aircraft prior to two off-duty aviators stepping in to assume command of the controls.

The plane was carrying more than 170 passengers and crew, most of them Israeli. Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu has said the suspect had undergone "Islamist radical indoctrination" and had attempted to crash the plane.



A FlyDubai aircraft takes off from Dubai International Airport in Dubai PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- Hamam al-Hammami informed investigators that his plan involved operating the flight in a routine manner after incapacitating the captain
- The plane was carrying more than 170 passengers and crew, most of them Israeli

The Wall Street Journal reported Friday that Omani authorities had barred the pilot from flying over suspicions he had adopted radical ideological views, citing people familiar with the matter.

Netanyahu has said Israel would check how the co-pilot had been cleared to work on flights to the country."

We have constraints that say that you can't have pilots from countries that don't have diplomatic relations with Israel," Netanyahu told Fox News.

Israel has said it does not believe any other members of the flydubai aircrew were involved in al-Hammami's attempt to crash the plane, according to Channel 12 news.

Channel 12 news also reported that the Omani co-pilot told his interrogators that he was acting "in revenge for Gaza," and "I wanted to die as a martyr."

The network also quoted two sources saying a Mossad official told Israeli cabinet ministers on Sunday that the al-Hammami made brief visits in recent years to several countries that are hostile to Israel.

US officials seek details of reported Russian plague death, quarantines



US President Donald Trump

AGENCIES
Washington, October 6

The Trump administration is closely tracking reports of a death potentially related to pneumonic plague in Russia, with officials cautioning that much about the situation remains unknown.

"We're looking at it very strongly, we just heard about it," President Donald Trump told reporters at the White House on Monday, adding that the United States would help Russia "as much as we can."

For their part, Russian authorities have defended that the epidemiological situation in the Irkutsk region is "stable," after having implemented several emergency measures in recent days following the death of the researcher in the alleged laboratory incident in Shelejov.

According to Moscow, specific protocols have already been activated after the event, which occurred on Friday at the Institute Against Plague in Siberia and the Far East.

Due to the position held by the deceased, "comprehensive epidemic measures" were introduced to contain any possible risk, including "identifying the broadest possible circle of people who may have been in contact with the patient," as detailed by the Federal Service for Surveillance on Consumer Rights Protection and Human Wellbeing of Russia (Rospotrebnadzor).

2 airports hit in renewed fighting with Houthis: Arab

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, October 6

Saudi Arabia said three people were injured in the latest attacks on its airports since fighting with Yemen's Houthi rebels reignited. Meanwhile, Palestinian officials said Israeli airstrikes in Gaza City killed two people, while condemning home demolitions in east Jerusalem and violence in the occupied West Bank.

Nearly three years after the Palestinian militant Hamas group's Oct. 7, 2023 attack on Israel, conflict in the Middle East has persisted almost without interruption, spreading across the region, including to Iran, Lebanon, Syria and Yemen.

Saudi Arabia's General Authority of Civ il Aviation said airports in the cities of Najran and Jizan were hit on Monday, damaging both facilities and leaving three lightly injured.

However, the statement didn't say who was responsible.

Pak, Turkiye agree to deploy forces in Saudi

Under recently signed trilateral pact

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Islamabad, October 6

Pakistan and Turkiye have agreed to deploy their military forces in Saudi Arabia under a recently concluded pact between the three countries.

The decision comes in the wake of attacks by Iran-backed Houthi rebels of Yemen in the Gulf country.

The three sides had convened an emergency wmeeting of the Strategic Political and Defence Committee (SPDC) of the Makkah Alliance for Defence in Riyadh on Monday to address the regional developments and threats facing Saudi Arabia, according to a joint statement.

The defence agreement, signed by Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkiye in August, establishes a framework for collective deterrence and stipulates that an armed attack against any one of them would be regarded as an attack against all.

Ukraine fires 900 drones at Russia

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 6

Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said Tuesday.

Unconfirmed media reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people.

Ukraine's domestically developed long-range drones and, increasingly,



missiles have allowed Kyiv to hit Russian soil during the more than 4.5 years since Moscow's forces launched a full-scale invasion.

It has hit targets as far east as the Urals and Siberia.

The bigger Russian military's air superiority during the war has made aerial attacks on civilian areas of Ukraine routine.

UN chief, Pakistan's Dy PM hold talks

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, October 6

Pakistan's Deputy Prime Minister Ishaq Dar on Tuesday met UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres here and discussed regional and global matters and also raised the Kashmir issue.

Guterres, whose second five-year term as UN chief ends in December 2026, arrived in Pakistan earlier in the day for a three-day official visit at the invitation of Dar, who is also the Foreign Minister.

"Discussions covered regional and global issues relating to peace and security, including Palestine, Jammu & Kashmir, Afghanistan, counter-terrorism, and the future of multilateralism," the Foreign Office said.

Dar briefed the UN chief on "Pakistan's positions on Jammu & Kashmir and the Indus Waters Treaty, reaffirming Pakistan's call for a just and peaceful resolution of the Kashmir dispute in accordance wwith relevant UNSC resolutions," it said in a statement.

Rising electricity demand deepens SE Asia's energy security concerns: IEA

Rapid industrialisation, urbanisation and rising living standards are driving Southeast Asia's energy demand

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Bangkok, October 6

Risks to Southeast Asia's energy supplies are multiplying faster than nations are coming up with solutions to meet rapidly rising demand for electricity, according to an International Energy Agency report released Tuesday.

Southeast Asia has a seemingly insatiable appetite for energy, but the region is now in a pinch as energy costs rise, partly due to the Iran war. Fast-growing Southeast Asian economies also need more electricity to power data centres and keep homes and businesses cool.

To beef up regional energy security, the report says Southeast Asian nations should share electricity amongst each other and diversify where they get their power.

But countries face multiple hurdles, from territorial conflicts between neighbours to differing types of national energy markets, according to analysts, who warn these barriers may keep the region



vulnerable to energy shocks.

"Southeast Asia is one of the world's most dynamic regions, but its rising needs for energy to power its economic growth face challenges in an increasingly uncertain global energy landscape," Fatih Birol, the IEA executive director, said in a statement.

With the Iran war now bleeding into its seventh month, the IEA warns energy security issues among the Association of Southeast Asian Nations will intensify as the region's electricity demands outpace growth in power generation.

THE ENERGY CRISIS STEMMING FROM THE CLOSURE OF THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ HAS BEEN A WAKE-UP CALL FOR SOUTHEAST ASIA, WHICH HAS SUFFERED FUEL SHORTAGES & SOARING COSTS

Rapid industrialisation, urbanisation and rising living standards are driving Southeast Asia's energy demand, which has risen almost 30 per cent per person over the last 10 years. From now until 2030, the IEA forecasts demand will expand at an average annual rate of 5.4 per cent because of demand for cooling, data centres and industry. The energy crisis stemming from the closure of the Strait of Hormuz has been a wake-up call for Southeast Asia, which has suffered fuel shortages and soaring costs.

Unlike their wealthier East Asian neighbours Japan and South Korea, countries in Southeast Asia have limited energy reserves and fewer resources for dealing with the crisis.

To survive, countries went into a state of energy triage to conserve power, while also burning more coal and buying Russian crude oil.

News at a glance

IHG Hotels signs agreement for 130-key voco Vrindavan

MUMBAI: IHG Hotels & Resorts on Tuesday said it has signed a management agreement with Vrindam Developers Private Limited for the development of voco Vrindavan, a 130-key hotel scheduled to open in the first quarter of 2031.

The signing will bring the voco brand to Vrindavan and mark Vrindam Developers' entry into the hospitality sector. "We are delighted to partner with Vrindam Developers Pvt Ltd on their first hospitality venture and look forward to bringing the voco experience to Vrindavan," IHG Hotels & Resorts Managing Director, South West Asia, Sudeep Jain said.

IEX electricity trade volume rises to 12.2 BU in September

NEW DELHI: Indian Energy Exchange (IEX) on Tuesday reported a 10.4 per cent year-on-year growth in electricity trade volume to 12.2 billion units (BU) in September. During Q2 FY27, IEX traded 39,685 MU, up 12.7 per cent year-on-year. The average market clearing price in the day-ahead market (DAM) rose 46 per cent to Rs 5.7/unit, while the real-time market price increased 49 per cent to Rs 5.2/unit.

India's energy consumption reached 502 BUs in Q2, up 11.5 per cent. In September, consumption rose 11 per cent to 162 BUs, while peak demand touched 269 GW on September 10, 2026.

TPREL adds 88,397 rooftop solar installations in Q2 FY27

NEW DELHI: Tata Power Solaroof, a division of Tata Power Renewable Energy Ltd (TPREL) on Tuesday reported a record 88,397 rooftop solar installations in Q2 FY27, up 33 per cent year-on-year, against 66,447 in Q2 FY26.

In H1 FY27, installations rose 50 per cent to over 1,68,530, while capacity rose 25 per cent to 801 MWp from 639 MWp. Cumulative installations reached 5,75,000 & capacity crossed 5.67 GWp. Uttar Pradesh led with 44,014 installations and around 172 MWp, followed by Maharashtra with 22,165 installations and close to 100 MWp in the six-month period.

Vedanta Aluminium Metal Q2 aluminium output rises 5%

NEW DELHI: Vedanta Aluminium Metal Ltd's aluminium production rose five per cent to 6,49,000 tonnes in Q2 of the current financial year from 6,17,000 tonnes a year ago, marking its highest-ever quarterly output.

The company's alumina production increased 37 per cent to 8,95,000 tonnes in the quarter ended September 30, 2026, driven by ramp-up and stabilisation of the expansion circuit.

Value-added production rose 31 per cent to 4,32,000 tonnes, supported by demand from the automotive sector and domestic downstream industries.

AUTOMOBILE RETAIL SALES UP 31.82% TO 25,36,920 UNITS IN SEPT

PV domestic retail sales rise 32.1% to 4,27,213 units in September: FADA

'September'26 was the best-ever September in Indian auto retail,' said Sai Giridhar, President of Federation of Indian Automobile Dealers

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 6

Passenger vehicle retail sales in India rose a robust 32.1 per cent year-on-year to 4,27,213 units in September even as the total automobile retail sales for the month were 25,36,920 units, registering a growth of 31.82 per cent over September 2025, Federation of Indian Automobile Dealers (FADA) said on Tuesday.

Two-wheelers' demand for the previous month recorded a 33.08 per cent at 17,90,188 units against 13,45,153 units in September 2025, while three-wheeler sales stood at 1,32,570 units, up 22.25 per cent from 1,08,444 units in the year-ago period.

At the same time, commercial vehicle sales grew 37.62 per cent year-on-year in September 2026 at 1,03,557 units, FADA said in a statement.

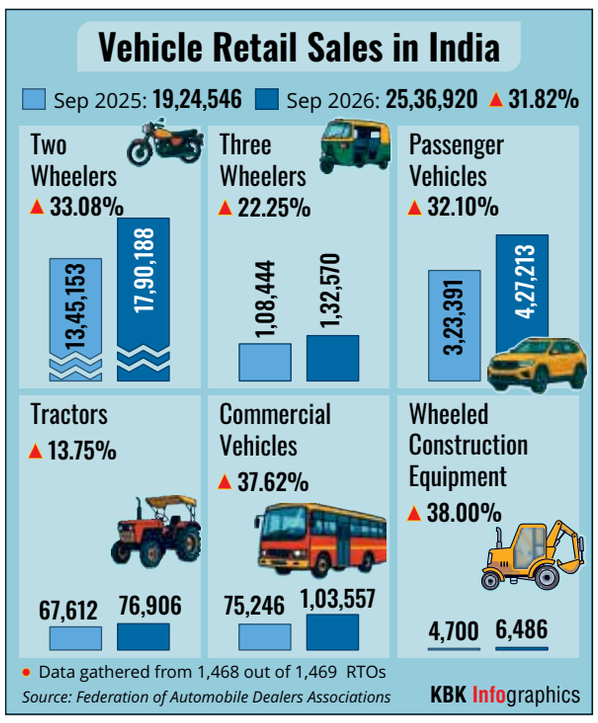
"September'26 was the best-ever September in Indian auto retail, with the industry registering 25,36,920 units, up 31.82 per cent YoY, which is the most base distorted print of the year -- a mirror of last September, when buyers deferred purchases in the week before GST 2.0 took effect on September 22, 2025," said Sai Giridhar, President, FADA.

It was the best-ever September across five of the FADA's six categories and, with it, the best-ever first half of any financial year at 1,55,12,319 units (+20.77 per cent), he said, adding that retail rose 4.69 per cent over August; and even setting the distorted September aside, FY27's first five months grew about 17 per cent, which is the truer underlying run-rate. Passenger vehicle retails were the best-ever September sales with urban and rural growing (markets) almost in lockstep at 32.11 per cent and +32.09 per cent YoY, respectively, FADA said.

The fuel mix offered the month's most watched signal: after alternative fuels overtook petrol for the first time in August, September saw the two settle into a near dead-heat, with petrol nudging marginally back ahead at 41.27 per cent against alternative fuels' 41 per cent (CNG at 23.11 per cent, hybrid 9.44 per cent, EV 8.45 per cent), it said.

The August crossover was therefore an inflection, not a decisive flip with petrol and alternative fuels now effectively at parity, trading the lead month to month, even as EV share rose to a fresh high and CNG eased.

"One year on from GST 2.0, affordability remains the single engine of this cycle -- and dealers now flag further price increases eroding that very affordability as their foremost risk for the quarter ahead. Protecting the GST gain is, to our mind, the key to converting the festive season into durable growth," Girdhar added. FADA said that overall, the outlook for October appears "cautiously optimistic" -- with festive conversion on auspicious days the key swing factor.



KEY POINTS

- It was the best-ever September across five of the FADA's six categories and, with it, the best-ever first half of any financial year at 1,55,12,319 units (+20.77 per cent), he said
- Passenger vehicle retails were the best-ever September sales with urban and rural growing (markets) almost in lockstep at 32.11 per cent and +32.09 per cent YoY, respectively, FADA said
- After alternative fuels overtook petrol for the first time in August, September saw the two settle into a near dead-heat, with petrol nudging marginally back ahead at 41.27% against alternative fuels' 41% , it said

Services sector growth touches three-month high in Sept: PMI

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 6

India's services sector growth touched a three-month high in September, as new orders increased sharply, supported by strengthening domestic demand, a monthly report said on Tuesday.

The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index rose to 55.2 in September, from 54.1 in August, signalling the strongest upturn since June.

The upturn in services sector activity, however, failed to lift the quarterly average above that seen in the previous period. "In fact, growth over the second fiscal quarter was the weakest since the three months to March 2022," the report said.

In the Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) parlance, a print above 50 means expansion, while a score below 50 denotes contraction.

S&P Global compiles the HSBC India Services PMI from responses to questionnaires sent to a panel of around 400 service sector companies.

According to the survey, growth in India's services sector was driven by increased demand for digital solutions, food, insurance, loans, software, transportation, and tours and travel. Moreover, international demand for Indian services improved, with panellists reporting gains from Germany, the UAE, the UK and the US.

GROWTH IN INDIA'S SERVICES SECTOR WAS DRIVEN BY INCREASED DEMAND FOR DIGITAL SOLUTIONS, FOOD, INSURANCE, LOANS, SOFTWARE, TRANSPORTATION, AND TOURS & TRAVEL

"The PMI survey suggested that India's services sector continued to improve, supported by strengthening domestic demand. At the same time, export business continued to expand, although the pace of growth slowed," said Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC.

On the job front, improving order books and projects in the pipeline prompted service providers to recruit extra staff during September. However, the rate of employment was softer than in August.

Meanwhile, cost pressures subsided at the end of the second fiscal quarter, with the rate of input price inflation retreating to its weakest since November 2025.

"Input-cost pressures on service providers eased to a 10-month low, reducing the need to raise selling prices. The outlook remained positive, with service providers reporting improved expectations for future activity for the second consecutive month," Bhandari added.

Going ahead, Indian services companies remained optimistic about the year ahead, supported by resilient demand and rising customer enquiries. Just under 16 per cent of respondents expect output to increase over the coming 12 months, while the remainder anticipate no change from current levels.

Meanwhile, the HSBC India Composite PMI Output Index rose to 55.9 in September, up from 54.3 in August, indicating the strongest upturn in private sector output since June.

Composite PMI indices are weighted averages of comparable manufacturing and services PMI indices. Weights reflect the relative size of the manufacturing and service sectors according to official GDP data.

As per the report, the reinstatement of job creation in the manufacturing industry and sustained growth at service providers resulted in greater employment at the composite level.

Mumbai Airport int'l flight: Govt asks Adani Airports, airlines to work on transition plan

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 6

The civil aviation ministry on Tuesday suggested delaying by a few weeks the proposed partial shifting of international flights from Mumbai airport to Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA), with stakeholders to finalise a transition plan, sources said.

Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha chaired a meeting with airlines, Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL), Federation of Indian Airlines, IATA and Airports Authority of India, among others. AAHL operates both airports.

AAHL has asked airlines to cut 33 per cent of international flights from Mumbai or discontinue them by October 25, citing the redevelopment of Terminal 1. Airlines have opposed the proposal.

Sinha asked airlines and AAHL to work on a firm transition plan. They will meet on October 13, followed by another meeting on October 20 to finalise the plan.

AAHL told the meeting that NMIA was prepared to handle up to 5 million international passengers annually, supported by connectivity, catering, hotels, lounges and other infrastructure.

Airlines said the ministry asked AAHL to re-engage stakeholders and submit the agreed transition plan as part of its request for approval of the Major Development Plan (MDP) for T1 redevelopment. MDP approval is required under the Mumbai airport concession agreement.

AAHL had said on October 3 that 91 per cent of Mumbai airport's passenger traffic would remain unaffected during T1 redevelopment. Work is scheduled to begin in January 2027, raising T1 capacity by 33 per cent to 20 mppa from 15 mppa.

MIAL has asked 46 airlines to cut international departure slots by 33 per cent from 11.59 pm on October 25. Of 770 weekly international flights from T2, 265 weekly overseas services are proposed to be temporarily discontinued. The vacated slots will facilitate domestic traffic shifting from T1.

FinMin asks pvt banks to increase particiaption in financial inclusion

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 6

The Finance Ministry on Tuesday urged private sector banks to raise participation in financial inclusion schemes, including Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY) & Stand Up India.

Financial Services Secretary Sanjay Lohiya, in a review meeting with heads of Public Sector Banks & senior officials of major private sector banks (PVBs), asked lenders to participate in the Financial Inclusion saturation drive from October 21 to December 31.

He urged PVBs to focus on marginalised sections and their banking needs. The meeting reviewed progress under PMJDY, PMJJBY, PMSBY, APY, PMMY, Stand Up India, PM SVANidhi, PM Vishwakarma, PM Surya Ghar and Kisan Credit Card schemes.

Progress on opening brick-and-mortar branches and deploying Banking Correspondents in unbanked villages was also reviewed.

Lohiya said banks should further expand digital outreach and focus on end-to-end digital loan processing. Working capital loans through credit lines on UPI and credit cards for micro-enterprises (CCME) were also discussed. He asked PVBs to raise awareness about claim eligibility under Jansuraksha insurance schemes and ensure nominees receive benefits. Banks were advised to address claim-related grievances carefully.

Lohiya also directed banks to enrol new PMJJBY and PMSBY beneficiaries through the Jan Suraksha portal, which will be integrated with banks and insurers. Measures to improve the persistency ratio of Atal Pension Yojana were also discussed.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Canara Bank, Circle Office Chandigarh, has entered into a strategic partnership with Himachal Pradesh State Electricity Board Ltd (HPSEBL) through the signing of an MoU. The exchange of MoU was led by Chander Singh Tomar, GM & Circle Head, Canara Bank Circle Office Chandigarh, accompanied by Ravi Kant Burman, Regional Head, Canara Bank Regional Office Shimla & Arjun Singh Thakur, Chief Auditor, Himachal Pradesh State Electricity Board Ltd.

'NBFC retail loan growth accelerates to 22% in Aug'

'Loans against gold jewellery rose 69.1% to about Rs 3.65 lakh cr in Aug'

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 6

Retail lending by non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) accelerated to 22 per cent year-on-year in August 2026 from 13.6 per cent a year ago, driven by stronger growth in housing and gold-backed loans, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data showed on Tuesday.

Loans against gold jewellery grew 69.1 per cent year-on-year to about Rs 3.65 lakh crore in August, remaining among the fastest-growing retail credit segments. Housing loan growth also accelerated to 12.1 per cent from 3.8 per cent a year ago.



Overall NBFC credit expanded 15.8 per cent to about Rs 60.64 lakh crore, against 10 per cent growth a year earlier. Vehicle loans grew 15.4 per cent, while consumer durable loans rose 56.4 per cent.

"Within retail loans, 'housing loans' and 'loans against gold jewellery' segments witnessed accelerated credit growth, while 'vehicle loans' maintained its robust growth with marginal uptick," the RBI said.

CLOSER LOOK

- 'Within retail loans, housing loans and loans against gold jewellery segments witnessed accelerated credit growth'
- 'Vehicle loans segment maintained its robust growth with marginal uptick,' the Reserve Bank data showed

Credit to agriculture and allied activities rose 17.4 per cent year-on-year in August, against 5.1 per cent a year ago. Industry credit growth was broadly stable at 8.4 per cent, compared with 8.3 per cent.

However, services-sector credit growth moderated to 16.2 per cent from 24 per cent. The RBI said commercial real estate credit expanded buoyantly, while growth in trade and transport operators decelerated.

The central bank said the data indicate stronger household-focused lending, with gold-backed borrowing continuing to grow rapidly. The sectoral credit data are based on a sample of NBFCs in the Upper and Middle Layers and housing finance companies, accounting for about 87 per cent of total credit covered by the RBI's reference data.

CCI approves JSW Group's proposed internal restructuring



AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 6

The Competition Commission of India (CCI) on Tuesday approved the proposed internal restructuring involving JSW Steel, JSW Projects & BMM Ispat.

JSW Projects currently holds a 58.47 per cent equity stake in BMM. The restructuring seeks to consolidate the JSW Group's majority interest in BMM into full ownership by amalgamating BMM into JSW Steel.

CCI said the move aims to improve operational, financial and organisational efficiencies through economies of scale. BMM operates an approximately one metric tonne per annum integrated steel manufacturing facility in Karnataka.

JSW Steel manufactures and sells iron and steel products, while JSW Projects produces iron ore pellets, sponge iron/DRI and captive power. In May, JSW Steel's board approved BMM's amalgamation at an enterprise value of Rs 6,400 crore.

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Janban Ahmed Sheikh S/O Bashir Ahmed Sheikh R/O HajipuraKulgam Kashmir is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 116/2019 U/S 8/15/29 NDPS Act of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids / efforts the accused could not be traced / still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Janban Ahmed Sheikh
S/O : Bashir Ahmed Sheikh
Address : HajipuraKulgam Kashmir
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4.SP City South	: 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East	:01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort	:0191-2475133

Sd/-
Sr,\. Superintendent of Police
DIP No:DIP/J-11849/26 Jammu

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) PROJECTDIVISION- III, JAMMU
SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Short e-NIT No. 107 of 2026-2027 Dated 05-10-202

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completeon	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Repair/Renovation of Govt Qtr no. 9 B Gandhi Nagar Jammu.CNo-356 NP	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	A, B, C& D
2	Repair/Renovation of Govt Qtr no. 35 B Gandhi Nagar Jammu.CNo-357 NP	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	A, B, C& D
3	Repair/Renovation of Govt. Qtr. No 6 E Panama Chowk Jammu.CNo-358 NP	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	2.88	600	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	A, B, C& D
4	Repair/Renovation of Govt Qtr no. 2 B Gandhi Nagar Jammu. CNo-359 NP	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	A, B, C& D
5	Repair/Renovation of Roller Shed Qtr No-12 by way of tiling work upgradation of wash room & kitchen & panelling (BC Road Jammu). CNo-360 NP	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	2.40	600	(2% of the Advertised Cost)	30 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 13-10-2026	A, B, C& D

Position of AAA : Accorded
Position of TS : Under Process
The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website http://jktenders.gov.inas per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	05-10-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 05-10-2026to 12-10-2026 upto1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	08-10-2026at 1200Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Project Division III, Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	05-10-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	12-10-2026upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	13-10-2026on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Project Division III, Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

No :-PWD(R&B)/PD-III/8884-94
Dated :05-10-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-11807/26
Sd/- (Er. Karanjeet Sing)
Executive Engineer
Project Division III, Jammu

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. AGC-EL-C-T-03-2026-27 **Date: 03.10.2026**
E-Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Const.), North Central Railway, Agra for and behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No. AGC-EL-C-T-03-2026-27	**Bid Security:** As per IREPS
Name of work with its location: Design, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of OHE Electrification (25 kV AC, 50 Hz) and PSI Works (SP/SSP) in connection with IDH Yard Remodelling (Phase-II) and OHE Electrification (2x25 Kv AC,50 Hz) of Bhandai Flyover for Etawah-bound Down Trains, Agra Division, N.C. Railway.	
Approx. Cost of the work: ₹ 19,34,68,649.4	
Completion Period: 12 Months from the date of issue of acceptance letter including monsoon period.	
Tender closing date & time: 26.10.2026 upto 15:00 hrs.	
Validity of offer: 90 days from the date of tender opening.	

Tenderers can only submit their offer through web portal **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:00** hrs on **26.10.2026.** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.** **2263/26(AK)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amit S/o** Jaljeet Singh **R/o** H.No. E-312, Mangolpuri, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 1413/17, U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Mangolpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Amit** the said accused of **FIR No. 1413/17, U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Mangolpuri, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.11.2026**

By Order
Ms. Reetika Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class,
North-West, Court No. 105,
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/14199/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 918 **Tender Notice** Date: 06/10/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), UJVN Ltd., Kalagarh, Pauri Garhwal, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders are given below:

Tender No.: 08/EE(Civil)/Kalagarh/Pauri Garhwal/2026-27, 09/EE(Civil)/Kalagarh/Pauri Garhwal/2026-27 & 10/EE(Civil)/Kalagarh/Pauri Garhwal/2026-27
Name of Work 1-: "Annual M & R work of Type - II residences at Hydel Colony Kalagarh"
2-: "Repair and Reconstruction work of damaged boundary wall at various location at Kalagarh"
3-: "Annual M & R work of Type -III &IV residences at Hydel Colony Kalagarh"
Estimated Cost: Rs. 24,87,257.74 (GST extra), Rs. 5,05,258.13 (GST extra) & Rs. 19,60,701.96 (GST extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: From 17:00 hrs of 07.10.2026
Last Date for submission of tender: Up to 15:00 hrs of 28.10.2026
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website, the tender document can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (Civil),
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunita Devi, W/o Sunil Kewat, R/o 1) H.No. E-4, Old No. 420/B, Gazipur, Delhi, 2) E-48, 420 B, Ghazipur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 148/2021, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sunita Devi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sunita Devi** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunita Devi** accused of **FIR No. 148/2021, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, Central
DP/13918/CD/2026 Room No. 150, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Smt. Nidhi Aggarwal** W/o Sh. Shivark Aggarwal, R/o G-3-39, G-3, Block Model Town-III, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI ACT 179/18 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Smt. Nidhi Aggarwal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Smt. Nidhi Aggarwal** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Smt. Nidhi Aggarwal** in **CC NI ACT 179/18 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026**.

By order
Sh. Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI ACT)-04
West District, Room No. 04 (ANNEX-I)
DP/14053/WD/2026 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
CARRIAGE & WAGON WORKS
Tender Notice : UPGR-LHBNAC-TOILET-1026

For and on behalf of President of India, Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage & Wagon Works, Southern Railway, Ayanavaram, Chennai -600 023 invites e-tender for the following work as per the tender notice given in e-tender portal **www.ireps.gov.in.**

Name of work	**UPGRADATION OF LHB NON-AC-COACH TOILETS**
Approximate cash value	**Rs. 44,50,77,292.00/-**
Bid security / Earnest Money	**Rs. 89,01,600.00/-**
Bidding Start Date	**15/10/2026**
Tender closing date and time	**29.10.2026 at 15.00 Hrs**
Cost of tender form	**Nil**
Period of Completion	**36 Months**
Website Address	**www.ireps.gov.in**
Office Address	**Chief Workshop Manager, Carriage & Wagon, Works, Southern Railway, Ayanavaram, Chennai – 600 023**

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
ICICI Home Finance | Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051
Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059
Branch Office: 307/1, 1st floor, Bishnoi Tower, Mangal Pandey Nagar, Opposite Apex Tower, Meerut- 250004
Branch Office: 1st Floor, 36, Defence enclave, Vikas marg, East Delhi- 110092

Whereas
The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/ her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited.
The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Jugnu Kumar (Borrower), Revti. (Co-Borrower), Kazmabad Goon Meerut Meerut-250005, LHMRT00001546823	A Plot Khasra No. 262 Mi, Situated In Village Bisokhar, Pargana Jalalabad, Tahsil Modi Nagar, District Ghaziabad, Mohalla Radha Kunj Ghaziabad 0 201001 Uttar Pradesh Total Area 80 Sq. Yards. i.e. 66.89 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By- North By: Arm 36 Ft Land of Buyer, South By: Arm 36 Ft Land of Buyer, East By: 18ft Wide Road And Arm 20 Ft, West By: Plot Deegar Malik And Arm 20 Ft./Date of Possession 01-10-2026	16-07-2026 Rs. 8,09,173/-	Meerut
2.	Jugnu Kumar (Borrower), Revti. (Co-Borrower), Kazmabad Goon Meerut Meerut-250005, LHMRT00001546837	A Plot Khasra No. 262 Mi, Situated In Village Bisokhar, Pargana Jalalabad, Tahsil Modi Nagar, District Ghaziabad, Mohalla Radha Kunj Ghaziabad 0 201001 Uttar Pradesh Total Area 80 Sq. Yards. i.e. 66.89 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By- North By: Arm 36 Ft Land of Buyer, South By: Arm 36 Ft Land of Buyer, East By: 18ft Wide Road And Arm 20 Ft, West By: Plot Deegar Malik And Arm 20 Ft./ Date of Possession 01-10-2026	16-07-2026 Rs. 27,078.34/-	Meerut
3.	Anmol Mathur (Borrower), Jayanti Mathur (Co-Borrower), Plot No. U-73 Vaishnav Nkv Enclave, Behind Sector 67, Badshahpur, Gurgaon- 122101, LHDLX00001695420	Unit No. 08, On First Floor (Front Tower Front Left Hand Side Second Unit), Without Roof Rights (Marigold Appartment) Khasra No. 774/3, Situated In The Extended Abadi of Lal Dora, Village Dera Mandi, Tehsil Mahrauli, New Delhi-110074, Total Area 87 Sq. Yards. With One Common Car Parking Bounded By- North By: Entry/ Passage/Road 25 Ft, South By: Passage/Other Unit/Other, East By: Unit No.07/Other Property, West By: Unit No.03/Other Property./ Date of Possession 03-10-2026	16-07-2026 Rs. 37,25,238/-	East Delhi-Laxmi Nagar
4.	Anmol Mathur (Borrower), Jayanti Mathur (Co-Borrower), Plot No. U-73 Vaishnav Nkv Enclave, Behind Sector 67, Badshahpur, Gurgaon- 122101, LHDLX00001704007	Unit No. 08, on First Floor (Front Tower Front Left Hand Side Second Unit), Without Roof Rights (Marigold Appartment) Khasra No. 774/3, Situated In The Extended Abadi of Lal Dora, Village Dera Mandi, Tehsil Mahrauli, New Delhi-110074, Total Area 87 Sq. Yards. With One Common Car Parking Bounded By- North By: Entry/ Passage/Road 25 Ft, South By: Passage/other Unit/Other, East By: Unit No.07/Other Property, West By: Unit No.03/Other Property./ Date of Possession 03-10-2026	16-07-2026 Rs. 85,649/-	East Delhi-Laxmi Nagar

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date : October 07, 2026
Place: Ghaziabad, Delhi
Authorized Office
ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

Government of Himachal Pradesh
Public Works Department
e-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
INVITING FOR BIDS (IFB).

The Executive Engineer, Killar Division HP.PWD., Killar(Pangi) on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the online bids on **Percentage Rate,** in electronic **tendering system,** in 2 cover System for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/Firm registered with HP.PWD.Department..

Sr No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost	Bid Security/ EMD	Cost of Document	Period of completion	Class
1	Link road from Gref Junction to Mall road at Killar Km 0/0 to 2/500 (Sub-Head:-Providing and Laying Interlocking paver block between km 0/860 to 2/410 , U-shape drain at Rd 1/050 to 1/180 and C/o Hume Pipe culvert at Rd 1/200 & 1/295) Under PDNA 2025	22020658.00	440413.00	7000/-	Six Month	A & B
1	**Start Date for downloading**	**06/10/2026 05:00 PM**				
2	**Deadline for submission of Bid:**	**13/10/2026 11:00 AM**				
5	**Date of Technical Bids Opening:**	**13/10/2026 11:30 AM**				

The undersigned has right to extend or cancel the bids without declaring any reasons there-of
Bidders documents can be downloaded from the website http:/hptenders.gov.in. The documents downloaded from the site should not be tempered, and if any such tempering is detected before or after the opening of bids, the bidder shall be penalized and black listed.
Other terms and conditions shall remain same as given in CPWD Manual 2019 and as per the bid document.

Executive Engineer
Killar Division,
Ro No 3920/2026-2027 HP.PWD.Killar(Pangi)
For and on behalf of the Governor of H.P.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE **Date: 01.10.2026**

For & on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (O&F), North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites OPEN E-Tenders in prescribed forms, from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability for the under mentioned work up to Date & time of closing of tender on GeM website-

GeM Bid No.: GEM/2026/B/8104738 Dated: 01.10.2026	
Name of work: Transportation of assembled wheel set from ROH Shed GMC/Kanpur to JHS workshop or any other nominated workshop over Indian Railways and overhauled wheel set from JHS workshop or any other nominated workshop to ROH Shed GMC/Kanpur for two years.	
Tender System: Two Packet System	**Tender Value (₹):** 3,81,23,460.00
EMD (₹): 3,40,700/-	**Cost of E- Tender Form:** Nil
Period of Work: 02 Years	**Bid End Date/Time:** 23.10.2026 & 15:00:00
Date of publishing on GeM website: 01.10.2026	

Note :- 1. The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-Tenders will be available/ uploaded since Date of publishing on GEM website and shall be remained on Website **www.gem.gov.in.** on the due date of tender closing. **2.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be acceptable against above tenders. For this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with GeM website. **3.** Document being attached should be signed by tenderer. **4.** E-Tender forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **5.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of GeM may be approached. **6.** Online E-Tender can be submitted up to date and time of closing of tender. **2255/26(AK)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.
Corporate Office: Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 028

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower/s (the "said Borrower"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s issued to them that are also given below.
In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to MHIL, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest at 2% p.m. as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to MHIL by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor/ Loan Account No./Branch	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Date of Demand Notice	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1.	Sanjay Varma/ Rekha Verma/ Sunil Kumar/ Prabhakar Verma/ 083-08300193/ Delhi	Rs. 14,76,236/- Rupees Fourteen Lakh Seventy Six Thousand Two Hundred Thirty Six Only.	26-Aug-2026	Residential Plot of Land Area Measuring 125 Sq. Yds. i.e. 104.51 Sq. Mtrs., Out of Khasra No. 348, Situated At Pooja Colony Village Pavisadakpur, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh East: Plot of Others West: Plot of Others North: Rasta 15 Ft. South: Plot of Others
2.	Rohit Kanaugiya/ Ankit Kannojiya/ Sarla Devi/ Rakesh Kanoijiya/ 058-05800301/ Noida	Rs. 15,52,706/- Rupees Fifteen Lakh Fifty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Six Only.	26-Aug-2026	All That Piece And Parcel of Residential Plot/ Land Measuring 100 Sq. Yards, Out of Khasra No. 263, Situated At Village Chhaprola, Pargana & Tehsil Dadri, District Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, Together With All Rights, Easements And Appurtenances Attached Thereto, Bounded As Follows: North: Vacant Plot; South: House of Santarpal Chandela; East: Vacant Plot; West: 18 Ft. Wide Road.
3.	Anuj Sharama/ Devendri/ GHA-NHL-000727 & GHA-NHL-000779/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 15,98,492/- & Rs. 9,09,141/- Rupees Fifteen Lakh Ninety Eight Thousand Four Hundred Ninety Two Only. & Rupees Nine Lakh Nine Thousand One Hundred Fourty One Only.	26-Aug-2026	All That Piece And Parcel of Freehold Residential House Bearing House No. 198, Admeasuring 494.98 Sq. Yards (Equivalent To 413.87 Sq. Mtrs.), Situated At Abadi Village Nibali, Tehsil & District Bagpat, Uttar Pradesh, Together With All Rights, Easements And Appurtenances Attached Thereto, Bounded As Follows: North: Road, 14 Ft. Wide; South: Other Land; East: House of Subhas; West: House of Rajakumar.
4.	Sagar Kumar/ Shyamo./ GHA-NHL-000723/ Ghaziabad	Rs. 11,03,294/- Rupees Eleven Lakh Three Thousand Two Hundred Ninety Four Only.	26-Aug-2026	All That Piece And Parcel of Freehold Residential House Bearing House No. 619, Admeasuring 657 Sq. Yards (equivalent To 549.33 Sq. Mtrs.), Out of Khasra No. 1031, Situated At Abadi Village Dhanaura, Silver Nagar, Tehsil & District Bagpat, Uttar Pradesh, Together With All Rights, Easements And Appurtenances Attached Thereto, Bounded As Follows: East: 15 Ft. Wide Road; West: House of Lal Singh; North: House of Man Singh; South: 10 Ft. Wide Road.

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to MHIL as aforesaid, MHIL shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences.
The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of MHIL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Date: October 07, 2026,
Place: Ghaziabad, Gautam Budh Nagar, Bagpat
Sd/-Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
GEM BID NO.: GEM/2026/B/8109880 **Dated:** 01.10.2026
E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

For & on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Coaching), Prayagraj North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites OPEN E-Tenders in prescribed forms, from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability for the under mentioned work up to Date & time of closing of tender on GeM website :

Name of work: Work of Data Entry and Material Handling during Maintenance of Coaching stock at PRYJ & CNB Coaching Depot for the period of Two Years.		
Tender system: Two packet system	**Tender Value:** ₹ 9,52,36,667/-	
EMD: ₹ 6,26,190/-	**Cost of Tender form:** Nil	**Period of Work:** 02 years
Date of publishing on GeM website: 01.10.2026		
Bid End Date/Time: 26.10.2026 At 15:00 Hrs.		

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-Tenders are available on GeM Website **www.GeM.gov.in. (2)** Online E-Tender can be submitted on GeM Website up to Date & time of closing of tender. **(3)** In case of any difficulty in submission of tender on GeM, helpdesk available on the GeM Website may be approached. **(4)** JV firms all allowed to participate in the tender. **2261/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

ICICI Home Finance
Corporate Office: ICICI Home Finance Company Limited ICICI HFC Tower, Andheri - Kurla Road, Andheri (East), Mumbai- 400059, India
Branch Office: 308A, 308B, 327A & 327B, 3rd Floor, DGE Block, Plot No.11, Golden-I, Greater Noida West, U.P-201301
Notice for sale of immovable assets through Private Treaty

Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets through Private Treaty under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 8(8) r/w Rule 9 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002
ICICI Home Finance Company Limited (ICICI HFC) conducted several e-Auctions for the sale of the mortgaged property mentioned below, however, all such e-Auctions failed. Now, an interested buyer has approached ICICI HFC with an offer to purchase the said property for an amount of Rs. 22,00,000/-. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below-described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd., will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is", by way of Private Treaty as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Legal Heirs. Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Out-standing	Reserve Price / Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of Auction	One Day Before Auction Date	Sarfaesi Stage
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)	(H)	(I)
1.	Ravneet Singh Chawla (Borrower) Paramjeet Kaur (Co-Borrower) Lan No. NHNOD00001216341	Flat No. 1902 19th Floor Antriksh Golf Links Tower A Plot No. GH-15A, Sector-01 Greater Noida-201307	Rs.81.66, 949/- Septe-mber 30, 2026	Rs. 22,00, 000/- / Rs.2,20, 000/-	October 16, 2026 11:00 AM To 03:00 PM	October 23, 2026 02:00 PM To 03:00 PM	October 22, 2026 before 04:00 PM	Symbolic Possession

The online auction will be conducted on website (URL Link- https://BidDeal.in) of our auction agency ValueTrust Capital Services Private Limited. The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) RTGS/ Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited, Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 22, 2026 before 04:00 PM. The Prospective Bidder(s) must also submit a signed copy of the Registration Form & Bid Terms and Conditions form at ICICI Home Finance Company Limited, Branch Office Address mentioned on top of the article on or before October 22, 2026 before 05.00 PM. Earnest Money Deposit Demand Draft (DD) should be from a Nationalized/Scheduled Bank in favor of "ICICI Home Finance Company Ltd. – Auction" payable at the branch office address mentioned on top of the article.
The general public is requested to submit their bids higher than the amount being offered by the interested buyer mentioned above. It is hereby informed that in case no bids higher than the amount being offered by the aforementioned interested buyer is received by ICICI HFC, the mortgaged property shall be sold to the said interested buyer as per Rule 8(8) r/w Rule 9 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
For any further clarifications with regards to inspection, terms and conditions of the sale or submission of bids, kindly contact ICICI Home Finance Company Limited on 9920807300.
The Authorized Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons.
For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please visit https://www.icicihfc.com/

Date: October 07, 2026
Place: Greater Noida
Authorized Officer, "ICICI Home Finance Company Limited"
CIN Number:- U65922MH1999PLC120106

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. MECH-ONF-WC-DER-26 **Date : 01.10.2026**
E-Tender Notice

For & on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (O&F), North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites OPEN E-Tenders in prescribed forms, from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability for the under mentioned work up to Date & time of closing of tender on GeM website

GeM Bid No.: GEM/2026/ B/8104814, Dated: 01-10-2026, **Name of work:** Additional work for the work of "Attention of repair of wagon during examination at ICD DER"	
Tender Value (₹) : ₹ 1,22,82,856.30	**EMD (₹) :** ₹ 2,11,500
Tender System: Two Packet System	**Cost of E-Tender Form:** Nil
Period of Work: 18 Months	**Date of publishing on GeM website:** 01.10.2026
Bid End Date/time: 23.10.2026 & 12:00	

Note: - (1) The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-tender will be available/uploaded since date of publishing on GEM website and shall be remained on website **www.gem.gov.in** on the due date of tender opening. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be acceptable against above tenders. For this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with GeM website. **(3)** Documents being attached should be signed by tenderer. **(4)** E-Tender forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **(5)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of GeM may be approached. **(6)** Online E-Tender can be submitted up to date and time of closing of tender. **2254/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

DRIVEN BY BETTER-THAN-EXPECTED PRINT FOR FIRST QUARTER

World Bank ups India's GDP growth projection to 7.1% for current fiscal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6

The World Bank on Tuesday raised India's GDP growth forecast for the current fiscal to 7.1 per cent, up 0.5 percentage points from its April projections, driven by better-than-expected print for the first quarter.

"We have upgraded our FY27 growth forecast to 7.1 per cent from 6.6 percent in April, as growth has held up better than expected despite trade and geopolitical uncertainties," the World Bank said in its latest India Development Update.

India's growth accelerated to 7.8 per cent in FY2025-26 from 7.2 per cent in FY2024-25, driven by strong investment and solid private consumption, as the favourable policy and credit environment outweighed trade tensions.

Rural consumption initially outpaced urban demand supported by strong agricultural performance, rural income support, food subsidies, and low inflation, while urban consumption strengthened later in the year following income-tax relief and GST cuts, it said.



'WE HAVE UPGRADED OUR FY27 GROWTH FORECAST TO 7.1 PER CENT FROM 6.6 PERCENT IN APRIL, AS GROWTH HAS HELD UP BETTER THAN EXPECTED DESPITE TRADE AND GEOPOLITICAL UNCERTAINTIES,' THE WORLD BANK SAID

The momentum has carried into FY2026-27, with GDP growing 7.8 per cent in Q1, above expectations, before moderating in subsequent quarters, it said.

Private consumption is expected to remain the main driver of growth although a rainfall deficit through August is likely to weigh modestly on rural demand, while subdued government consumption will stay muted, it said.

The investment outlook is broadly unchanged, with heightened global uncertainty weighing on private investment as frontloading fades, partly offset by supportive financial and policy conditions, including stronger public investment, it said.

India's exports have performed better than expected and are likely to provide the main upside to the FY2026-27 growth outlook relative to the April forecasts, it said.

On the supply side, it said, the industry is now forecast to perform better than initially expected and offset a weaker agricultural outlook.

Since April, industrial activity has exceeded expectations despite global headwinds.

This partially reflects the stronger-than-expected front-loading earlier in the year, with infrastructure and construction goods growth accelerating to 7 2 per cent in first quarter from 6.1 per cent last year, as well as the higher summer utility demand, which drove the electricity sector to expand by 9.3 per cent in Q1 compared to a 1.5 per cent contraction last year.

Although above-average rainfall since July narrowed the monsoon deficit, the overall rainfall shortage during southwest monsoon has weakened agricultural prospects, it said.

The World Bank also said the services sector growth remained elevated despite a slowdown from the high base in FY2025-26.

KEY POINTS

- India's growth accelerated to 7.8% in FY2025-26 from 7.2% in FY2024-25, driven by strong investment and solid private consumption
- Rural consumption initially outpaced urban demand supported by strong agricultural performance, rural income support, food subsidies, and low inflation
- Urban consumption strengthened later in the year following income-tax relief and GST cuts, it said
- 'Momentum has carried into FY27, with GDP rising 7.8% in Q1, before moderating in subsequent quarters'

Govt considering to revive ATF price stabilisation fund for airlines

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 6



Amid rising jet fuel prices, the government is considering whether to revive the price stabilisation fund and is also in discussions with airlines as well as oil marketing companies on the high ATF costs.

Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) accounts for around 40 per cent of an airline's operational expenses, and with the continuing West Asia turmoil, fuel prices have been on the rise.

"One of the most important things is how the West Asia crisis is putting a big burden on ATF prices. We are in discussions with airlines and OMCs (Oil Marketing Companies)," Civil Aviation Minister K Rammohan Naidu said on the sidelines of a conference in the national capital on Tuesday.

The government is considering whether to have the price stabilisation fund for the ATF, according to a senior official. Specific details could not be immediately ascertained.

In June, the Union Cabinet cleared a one-time budgetary support not exceeding Rs 10,000 crore for Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs) to provide ATF price stabilisation in order to provide support for domestic airlines.

However, airlines were not keen on availing the fund, which has lapsed now.

On Monday, the country's largest airline IndiGo announced a hike in fuel surcharge for domestic and international flights in the wake of rising jet fuel prices. IndiGo had said ATF prices have remained volatile in recent months, especially following the geopolitical situation in the Middle East.

According to the airline, the continuous rise in fuel prices, with the latest month-on-month increase exceeding 14 per cent, has taken ATF costs to levels that are amongst the highest in the last decade.

Last month, the Federation of Indian Airlines (FIA) has sought a review of the existing jet fuel pricing formula, saying that domestic ATF should be priced on the actual cost of fuel plus a reasonable margin rather than international benchmark pricing.

FIA represents Air India, IndiGo and SpiceJet.

The unprecedented increase in fuel costs, compounded by geopolitical disruptions and rupee depreciation, is placing significant pressure on airline cash flows and viability, it had said in a letter to the civil aviation ministry.

Further, the civil aviation minister expressed hope that India will have its first indigenous civilian aircraft within two years through a joint venture, highlighting the sector's growing potential.

Airlines have more than 1,600 aircraft on order, estimated at about $100 billion, while over 100 new airports are expected in the next 10 years. India currently has 165 airports and domestic airlines operate around 850 aircraft.

Naidu said Boeing and Airbus currently source components and services worth around $4 billion from India, expected to reach $10 billion by the decade-end. He also said India could manufacture jet engines, though it would be time-consuming, and has potential to export Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF).

Briefs

Rupee settles unchanged at 96.35/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee settled unchanged at 96.35 against the US dollar on Tuesday as retreating crude prices helped the currency resist pressure from sustained outflows of foreign capital and geopolitical uncertainties.

At interbank forex, rupee opened at 96.29 & traded between 96.29-96.45 before settling at previous session's closing level of 96.35.

Steel demand to rise 8-10% in H2 FY27

NEW DELHI: Domestic steel demand is expected to grow 8-10 per cent in the second half of FY27, Tata Steel CEO and MD T V Narendran said Tuesday.

On the proposed Netherlands project, Narendran said Tata Steel was engaging with the Dutch government to resolve issues before signing a binding agreement.

These include coke oven closure and classification and handling of steel slag at its IJmuiden facility.

MDR cannot be passed on to consumers: Punjab & Sind Bank

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 6

Merchants accepting UPI payments cannot pass Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) charges to customers, who will continue to pay only the price displayed by merchants after October 15, Punjab & Sind Bank MD and CEO Swarup Kumar Saha said.

From October 15, UPI merchant payments (P2M) above Rs 2,000 will attract a 0.4 per cent MDR, capped at Rs 300. Person-to-person transactions will remain free regardless of the amount.

"Merchants onboarded cannot pass on MDR charges to customers while accepting payments through UPI. The framework ensures consumers pay only the posted price," Saha said.

He said transactions up to Rs 2,000, accounting for more than 95 per cent of total UPI (P2M) volume, would remain unaffected.

Saha said reasonable MDR would support the long-term sustainability of the UPI ecosystem while keeping it accessible for transactions.

Merchants are likely to absorb nominal digital processing costs as operational overheads, offset by higher business volumes, increased footfall and reduced cash-handling risks, he said.

For specified merchant categories, including railways, telecom services, insurance and fuel, a flat MDR of Rs 5 will apply to transactions above Rs 2,000, instead of the 0.4 per cent variable rate.

The fixed fee is intended to prevent cost escalation in public services, utility collections and thin-margin sectors such as fuel retail. Fuel purchases at petrol stations above Rs 2,000 will attract the Rs 5 fee, while payments below Rs 2,000 will continue to carry zero MDR, ensuring charge-free everyday refuelling.

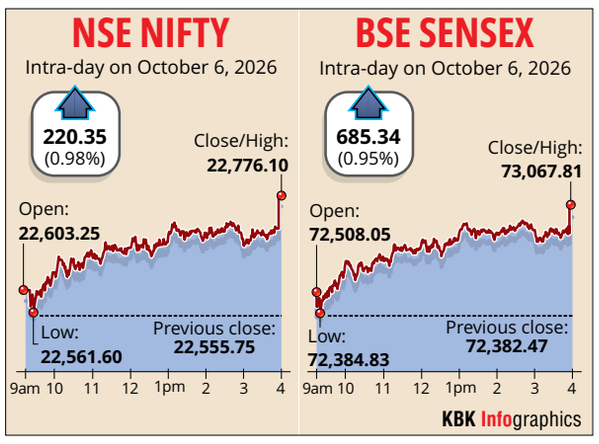
Markets rise for 2nd day, Sensex soars 685 pts on easing oil prices & buying in bank stocks

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 6

Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended sharply higher on Tuesday, extending their rally for the second straight session, as a decline in crude oil prices below $100 per barrel and buying in bank stocks and Reliance Industries added to investors' optimism.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 685.34 points, or 0.95 per cent, to settle at 73,067.81. The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 220.35 points, or 0.98 per cent, to end at 22,776.10.

From the 30 Sensex firms, Trent surged the most by 12.78 per cent.



Kotak Mahindra Bank, Hindustan Unilever, Reliance Industries, InterGlobe Aviation, Eternal and Asian Paints were also among the winners.

Tech Mahindra, Titan, Bajaj Finance and ITC were among the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, tanked 1.70 per cent to $98.59 per barrel.

The BSE SmallCap Select index jumped 1.25 per cent and the MidCap Select index 1 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Telecommunication surged 2.33 per cent, Capital Goods 1.79 per cent, Industrials 1.62 per cent, FMCG 1.57 per cent, Power 1.21 per cent, Oil & Gas 1.21 per cent and Insurance 1.06 per cent.

Realty, IT, PSU Bank, Hospitals, Focused IT, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt and MidSmall Private Banks ended lower.

FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 4,699.14 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

Adani Power, DGPC sign agreement for setting up 770 MW hydropower project in Bhutan

MPOST BUREAU
Ahmedabad, October 6



Adani Power and Bhutan's state-owned Druk Green Power Corp. Ltd. (DGPC) on Tuesday signed a Shareholders Agreement for developing the 770 MW Chamkharchhu-I Hydroelectric Project in Bhutan.

The project is the second major hydropower collaboration between the partners after the 570 MW Wangchhu Hydroelectric Project agreement signed in September 2025. It is part of the broader 5,000 MW hydropower development MoU signed between Adani Group and DGPC in May 2025.

Located in Zhemgang District, the peaking run-of-river project will be developed under the BOOT model through a 49:51 equity partnership between Adani Power and DGPC, with a 30-year concession from COD. Construction is expected to begin in the first half of 2027, with commissioning targeted six years after groundbreaking.

The project will strengthen Bhutan's energy security and facilitate surplus clean power exports to India, supporting regional energy cooperation.

Adani Airport launches Swirl Transit Hotel at Navi Mumbai Int'l Airport

MPOST BUREAU
Navi Mumbai, October 6

Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL), India's largest private airport operator, has launched Swirl Transit Hotel, an 80-room transit hotel at Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA), offering travellers accommodation for resting, refreshing or working within the airport.

Located on the Arrivals Level of Terminal 1, the two-floor hotel caters to passengers with long layovers, early departures, late arrivals and short-stay requirements. Guests can choose four-hour or overnight stays, with access to showers, dining and hotel services.

Suchit Bansal, CEO, Non-Aero Business, AAHL, said the facility brings accommodation into the airport environment, offering travellers flexibility between flights. He said AAHL sees an opportunity to take the proposition to other airports across its network.

NMIA commenced commercial operations on 25 December 2025 and began global operations on July 29, 2026 with its first international flight to Abu Dhabi.

The hotel has 80 rooms across six categories, ranging from 130 sq. ft to 410 sq. ft & offers Wi-Fi, smart televisions, workstations, electronic safes, dining and housekeeping services.

AAHL plans to introduce the Swirl concept at Lokpriya Gopinath Bardoloi International Airport zin Guwahati, where a 21-room property is planned.

It will offer hourly and overnight stays, dining & hospitality services.

India's manufacturing sentiment improved in July-Sept

Rebound in the sentiment in Q2 FY27, indicates signs of recovery from West Asia crisis

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 6

India's manufacturing sentiment improved in the July-September quarter, with factories reporting higher capacity utilisation and higher or same production levels compared with the previous quarter, according to the latest FICCI Manufacturing Survey released on Tuesday.

The survey covered around 225 firms across nine major sectors, including automotive and auto components, capital goods, chemicals, electronics and electricals, glass, machine tools, metals, textiles, apparels and technical textiles. Respondents from large and SME manufacturing units had a combined annual turnover of over Rs 2 lakh crore.

FICCI said the findings indicated a rebound in production sentiment in Q2 2026-27, signalling recovery from the West Asia crisis. While 77 per cent of respondents reported higher or same production in Q1 FY 2026-27, the share rose to approximately 95 per cent in Q2.

Demand also improved, with 90 per cent reporting higher or same orders in Q2 FY 2027, compared with 77 per cent in the previous quarter.

Average capacity utilisation rose to close to 75 per cent from 72 per cent in the previous quarter. The investment outlook remained steady for the next six months, though manufacturers cited geopolitical uncertainty, tariffs, trade restrictions, demand uncertainty, skill shortages, raw material availability, logistics costs and regulatory challenges as constraints.

Around 89 per cent of respondents reported higher or same inventory in Q2 2026-27, against around 91 per cent in Q1. Exports also improved, with around 80 per cent reporting higher or same exports in Q2 against the previous year's corresponding quarter, against 74 per cent in first quarter of FY2026-27.

FICCI said 43 per cent planned to hire additional workforce over the next three months, up from 35 per cent in the last quarter.

However, the average interest rate paid by manufacturers increased to 9.1 per cent in Q2 from 8.9 per cent.

Nearly 83 per cent reported higher production costs as a percentage of sales, against 79 per cent previously.

CLOSER LOOK

- While 77 per cent of respondents reported higher or same production in Q1 FY 2026-27, the share rose to approximately 95 per cent in July-September quarter of current fiscal
- Demand also improved, with 90 per cent reporting higher or same orders in July-September quarter of FY27, compared with 77 per cent in the previous quarter

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



POWERGRID has established the 'POWERGRID Centre of Excellence' at Punjab Engineering College (PEC), Chandigarh, under its CSR initiative. Vamsi Rama Mohan Burra, CMD, POWERGRID, handed over the centre of excellence to Prof. Rajesh Kumar Bhatia, Director, PEC, Chandigarh on October 5, 2026 in the presence of Yatindra Dwivedi, Director (Personnel), POWERGRID, Akhilesh Pathak, Director (Projects), POWERGRID, Naveen Kumar, CVO, POWERGRID, Tarun Bajaj, ED, Northern Region-II, POWERGRID

WITH AGARKAR GONE

Bhuvneshwar makes India comeback after four years

ASSOCIATED PRESS
New Delhi, October 6

Veteran India seamer Bhuvneshwar Kumar on Tuesday returned to the national side after nearly four years for the upcoming five-match T20I series in New Zealand later this month.

The 36-year-old Meerut-born Bhuvneshwar, who played a stellar role in Royal Challengers Bengaluru's back-to-back IPL titles with 17 wickets in the 2025 season and 28 wickets in 2026, tormented the best in the business with swing and seam movement in powerplay overs.

It is understood that Central Zone selector Rudra Pratap Singh never found much support when it came to the inclusion of Bhuvneshwar but once Agarkar was gone, it wasn't very difficult to convince Pragyan Ojha and the other colleagues about the value of the experienced seamer in the absence of Jasprit Bumrah.

कार्यालय नगर परिषद केलारस जिला मुरैना (म.प्र.)

क्रमांक/नि.शा./2026/2795 — कोलारस, दिनांक 06.10.2026

//ई–निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना//

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्रीयकृत पंजीयन प्रणाली में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से ऑन लाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण बेवसाईट https:mptendars.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

क्रं.	टेण्डर क.	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की समयावधि एवं लागत	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य एवं अमानत राशि	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
1	2026_UAD_540394_1	एम.एस. रोड नहर से लेकर नगर पालिका के समाने तक आर.सी.सी. नाला निर्माण कार्य	1वर्ष वर्षाकाल सहित 204.58 लाख	15,000/– 1,02,300/–	05.11.2026 05:30 PM

नोटः– निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन का प्रकाशन वेबसाइट https:mptendars.gov.in पर ही किया जावेगा, पृथक से समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित नहीं किया जायेगा।

अंजना ब्रजेश
अध्यक्ष
नगर परिषद केलारस

राम प्रकाश जगनेरिया
मुख्य नगर पालिका अधिकारी
नगर परिषद केलारस

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Jhajjar Kotli, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Sharu Khan alias Sharu S/O Tariq Mohd R/O Sandrote Tehsil Dansal District, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 97/2026 U/S 223 RPC of P/S Jhajjar Kotli, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	:	**Sharu Khan alias Sharu**
S/O	:	**Tariq Mohd**
Address	:	**Sandrote Tehsil Dansal District, Jammu**
Age	:	**24 years**
Height	:	**5'8"**
Complexion	:	**Fair**
Eyes	:	**Black**

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	:0191-2605949
4.SP Rural Jammu	: 0191-2605949
5.SDPO Nagrota	:0191-2673666
6.SHO P/S Jhajjar Kotli	:0191-2668008

Sd/-
Sr,\. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-11847/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E- TENDERING NOTICE

Sr.Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No. - JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-21

Description of work- Reconditioning of Traction Power (132kV/25kV. 21.6 MVA single phase) Transformer in Jhansi Division.

Approx Cost (Rs.)-72,52,212.64	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.)-1,45,100**

Date of closing Tender - 28.10.2026 15:00 pm.

Date of completion /period from issue acceptance letter - 09 Months

- Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs on **28.10.2026**
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in** **2266/26 (D)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. JHS-N-W-79-26 **Date: 05.10.2026**
E-TENDERING NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line **(E-Tendering)** for the following works.

Description of work:- Provision of S&T work in connection with Construction of PQRS siding at BURHPURA station.

Approx Cost:- Rs.7188689.18	**Earnest Money:-** Rs. 143800/-
Cost of Tender Form:- Nil	**Opening of tender:-**30.10.2026 Time 15:00
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance:- 12 Months	

- Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00 hrs** on **30.10.2026**.
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in. (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T)** **2274/26(D)**

North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
NO. SG-664-06-Tele-2026-27

E-TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDER MENTIONED WORK. **(1) Name of the work:** Provision of CIB, TIB and Auto Announcement with IPIS system at MESR and HZBN station. **(2)Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 2,24,85,664.58 **(3)Earnest Money:** Rs. 4,49,700.00 **(4)Date & time for closing of tender:** 23.10.2026 (12:00 Hrs) **(5)Any E-Tenders which is sent by Post/Courier / FAX or self, Manual proposals although the letter is on firms letter pad or received in time will not be accepted.** The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. **http//www.ireps.gov.in** **Note:** Tenderers are requested to visit the website **http//www.ireps.gov.in** atleast 10 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.

Sr. D.S.T.E
East Central Railway, Dhanbad
PR/1060/DHN/S&T/T/26-27/32

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
No. ECR-CAO-C-S-ETEN-DOS-09

E-tender is invited on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work: - **(1) E-Tender No.:** ECR-CAO-C-S-ETEN-DOS-09 in Two packet system, **Name of Work:** Construction of Station Building (New Kastha & New Rafiganj) and other ancillary civil engineering works under proposed alignment in connection with 3rd & 4th line of DFCC under DDU Division of E C Railway. **Approx Cost of the Work (in Rs.):** 14,82,80,157.14, **Bid Security:** 29,65,600.00, **Period of Work Completion:** 12 (Twelve) Months, **Date and time for closing of tender:** 26.10.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. Any e-tender which is sent by Post/Courier/Fax or by hand will not be accepted. All such manual submission of tender, even if it is on firm's letter pad or received in time, will not be accepted. The above e-tender document along with full information is available on website **http://www.ireps.gov.in**. Note: In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website **http://www.ireps.gov.in** at least 15 days before last date of closing, for latest corrigendum/ corrections etc in connection with this e tender.

Deputy Chief Engineer (Construction)
East Central Railway, Dehri On Sone
PR/1063/CONSTRUCTION DOS/ENGG/T/26-27/36

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC/
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Jitender Gupta @ Lalua S/o Harishankar R/o K-276, Shakurpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 178/26 Dt. 05.04.2026 U/s 109(1)/115(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at PS: Subhash Place, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jitender Gupta @ Lalua** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitender Gupta @ Lalua** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jitender Gupta @ Lalua of FIR No. 178/26 Dt. 05.04.2026 U/s 109(1)/115(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 of PS: Subhash Place, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 16.11.2026.**

By order
Upasana Satija
Chief Judicial Magistrate
North-West, Room No.108, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13890/NW/2026

DHANVANTRI LIBRARY
UNIVERSITY OF JAMMU
(NAAC Accredited "A++" Grade University)
Expression of Interest for Empanelment of Journals Suppliers/Vendors

Dhanvantri Library, University of Jammu, invites Expression of Interest (EOI) for the empanelment of Suppliers/Vendors for the supply of Journals/Periodicals during the financial year 2026–27. Expression of Interest is invited from Interested suppliers, vendors/ publishers and distributors. Sealed offers accompanied by a **DD of Rs. 7000/- (Rupees Seven Thousand Only)** pledged to the **I/C Librarian, Dhanvantri Library, University of Jammu** along with requisite documents should reach to the Office of the undersigned by or before **10th October, 2026 up to 3:00 P.M sharp**. The detailed Empanelment Criteria, Terms & Conditions and Application Format can be downloaded from the University website.

For further information, please visit:
Website: https://www.jammuuniversity.ac.in
Email: periodicalsection@jammuuniversity.ac.in
Ph: 9419175479

No: JU/DLJ/26/1758
Dated : 01-10-2026
DIP No:DIP/J-2452-P/26

Sd/-
I/c LIBRARIAN

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE FOR THE SUPPLY OF STORES NO E-21/2026

THE FOLLOWING E-TENDERS/ CORRIGENDA ARE PUBLISHED IN IREPS WEBSITE. FIRMS ARE REQUESTED TO LOGIN TO **http://www.ireps.gov.in-login>e.tender-goods &services (new)** AND QUOTE AGAINST THESE TENDERS. MANUAL QUOTATIONS WILL NOT BE ENTERTAINED FOR THESE TENDERS. CLOSING TIME FOR ALL TENDERS 14:30 HOURS

Sl. No.	TENDER NO	DESCRIPTION	DUE DATE	QUANTITY
1.	04260976	PAD FOR SECONDARY SUSPENSION	15/10/2026	2889 NOS
2.	90266572A	BRAKE CYLINDER 11" WITH DOUBLE ACTING AUTOMATIC SLACK ADJUSTER	20/10/2026	155 NOS
3.	90266856	BRAKE CYLINDER 11" WITH DOUBLE ACTING AUTOMATIC SLACK ADJUSTER AND HAND BRAKE CABLE ASSEMBLY	20/10/2026	140 NOS
4.	01260023B	PAINT - WHITE	22/10/2026	100380 LTR
5.	03267057	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF 1 IN 8.5 TWS TURNOUT	22/10/2026	3 ITEMS
6.	11260015A	WELDING CABLE SINGLE CORE FLEXIBLE	22/10/2026	11000 MTR
7.	44260635A	FLAP DOOR FOR BCNA & BCNAHS WAGONS	23/10/2026	2673 NOS
8.	01260048C	PAINT ALUMINIUM FOR GENERAL PURPOSE	23/10/2026	80880 LTR
9.	26260611	MAIN COMPRESSOR COMPLETE UG WITHOUT MOTOR	23/10/2026	39 NOS
10.	26263662	ROLLER BEARING	26/10/2026	717 NOS
11.	26261063	AXLE BOX BEARING FOR WAG9/WAP7 LOCOMOTIVES	26/10/2026	279 NOS
12.	03267055	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF 1 IN 8.5 OVER-RIDING DERAILING SWITCH	26/10/2026	2 ITEMS
13.	29261034	OVERHAULING KIT FOR ENGINE WOODWARD	26/10/2026	122 SET
14.	78266564	4 X 1.5, 18 X 1.5, 25 X 1.5 AND 2 X 1.5 SQ MM MULTICORE SCREENED	26/10/2026	4 ITEMS
15.	78266588	SINGLE CORE ELECTRON BEAM IRRADIATION	26/10/2026	7 ITEMS
16.	90266205	HIGHER CAPACITY AIR SPRING 180KN	26/10/2026	51 NOS
17.	06260057	D T SYNTHETIC RESIN BONDED LP SHEET COLOUR "STAR DUST GREY"	27/10/2026	12157 NOS
18.	03267053	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF CMS CROSSING 1 IN 12	27/10/2026	300 SET
19.	26260026	CONTACT LEVER COMPLETE FOR N32 TAP CHANGER	27/10/2026	895 NOS
20.	15260144B	CARBON CONTACT FOR Q RELAYS	28/10/2026	698028 NOS
21.	15260226A	COVER ASSEMBLY & KEY BOX ASSEMBLY	28/10/2026	5897 SET
22.	04261167A	C3W DISTRIBUTOR VALVE FOR LHB COACHES	29/10/2026	122 NOS
23.	03267056	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF TWSEJ (ASSEMBLY)	29/10/2026	2013 SET
24.	03267016	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF HIGH VISCOUS NYLON-66	30/10/2026	3797527 NOS
25.	03267031	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF PSC TURNOUT SLEEPER 1 IN 12	30/10/2026	218 SET
26.	44261053	TOGGLE ASSEMBLY	30/10/2026	8912 SET
27.	82265272A	ONAN/ONAF TYPE TRACTION POWER TRANSFORMER	30/10/2026	3 NOS
28.	15260215A	CONTACTOR UNIT ASSEMBLY	02/11/2026	6970 SET
29.	11264199	SOLID RDSO PORCELAIN 9 TONNE INSULATOR	03/11/2026	1609 NOS
30.	15261046A	BASE (CAST IRON MACHINED) FOR 220MM STROKE POINT MACHINE	03/11/2026	4354 SET
31.	03267049	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF TURNOUT PSC SLEEPER FOR 1 IN 8.5	04/11/2026	151 SET
32.	15260258A	BASE (CAST IRON MACHINED) FOR 143MM STROKE ELECTRIC POINT MACHINE	04/11/2026	521 NOS
33.	15260227A	POWER TRANSMISSION ASSEMBLY	04/11/2026	698 SET
34.	04263469A	OUTER BRACKET (RH) FOR BIO-TANK	04/11/2026	1278 NOS
35.	01264369B	SUPPLY OF INNOCULUM (ANAEROBIC-BACTERIA FOR BIO-TOILETS)	05/11/2026	1163840 LTR
36.	51266031	AXLE GUIDE BEARING FOR VB	09/11/2026	589 NOS
37.	03267060	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF NYLON CORD REINFORCED GRSP	10/11/2026	3 ITEMS
38.	15261047A	POWER TRANSMISSION ASSEMBLY	11/11/2026	4781 SET
39.	03267059	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF NYLON CORD REINFORCED GRSP	20/11/2026	3 ITEMS
40.	03267058	RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF 1 IN 16 CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING	25/11/2026	88 SET

THE FOLLOWING CORRIGENDA ARE PUBLISHED IN IREPS WEBSITE. FIRMS ARE REQUESTED TO LOGIN to http://www.ireps.gov.in-login> e.tender-goods & SERVICES (NEW) FOR DETAILS:

TENDER NOTICE NO. E-20/2026, ITEM SL. NO.38, TENDER NO. 03267052 DUE DATE: 22/10/2026 – RC FOR MANUFACTURE AND SUPPLY OF 1 IN 8.5 CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING

FIELD NAME: TENDER CLOSING DATE TIME	EXISTING: 22/10/2026 @ 14.30	READ AS: 28/10/2026@14:30

PRINCIPAL CHIEF MATERIAL MANAGER

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer, S. E. Railway, Adra, Pin-723121, West Bengal invites e-tender for the following work : **Tender Notice No. : SnT_e_Tender_ ADA_26_27_35; Name of the work :** S&T work in connection with the replacement and implementation of overaged 25watt Very High Frequency (VHF) sets, with a centralised audio recording facility, in Adra division; **Tender Value :** ₹ 1,62,81,306.63. **Closing date & time of tender :** 23/10/2026 at 11:00 hrs. Details are available at website **www.ireps.gov.in.** **(PR-857)**

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Tariq Paray S/O Abdul Gani Paray R/O Village Lower Monda, QaziqundAnnatnag, Kashmir is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 172/2017 U/S 279/337 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids / efforts the accused could not be traced / still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	:	**Tariq Paray**
S/O	:	**Abdul Gani Paray**
Address	:	**Village Lower Monda, QaziqundAnnatnag, Kashmirr**

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1.DPO, Jammu	:0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu	:0191-2605949
4.SP City South	: 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East	: 01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort	: 0191-2475133

Sd/-
Sr,\. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-11845/26

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Vivek Tomar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), , Bahadurgarh
Satbir
Vs.
General Public
CASENO. SUCC/19/2026
CNR NO. HRJRA0-001057-2026
NEXT DATE:- 15-12-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
:-
General Public

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **15-12-2026** at **10:00.a.m.** For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district Notice&district=Jhajjar**

Sd/-Sh. Vivek Tomar
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
date 05-10-2026 **Bahadurgarh**

Executive Engineer
P. W. Division No. 1 Nagpur
INVITATION FOR TENDERS
e-mail div1nagpur.ee@mahapwd.com
E-Tender Notice No ४१ / RAC /2026-27
OPEN TENDER

Online tenders in B-1 are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division No. 1, Nagpur for the following work from P.W.D. Registered Contractors. The name of work, estimated cost, time limit for completion etc. are as under.

SR No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In lakh)	Cost of Blank Tender Form	Time limit in Tender (Calendar Months)
1	Replacement of Roofing of M/C No. 3-4 & 5-6 at Nagbhavan, Nagpur	58.82	११८०/-	१ महिना
2	Water proofing to terrace slab in patches in Wing No.2 ,MLA Hostel,civil lines Nagpur RAC-2026.	50.42	११८०/-	१ महिना
3	Water proofing to terrace slab in patches in Wing No.1 ,MLA Hostel,civil lines Nagpur RAC-2026.	58.82	११८०/-	१ महिना
4	Construction of Septic Tank at 160 Tenament Civil line, Nagpur.	50.42	११८०/-	१ महिना
5	Repairs and renovation to Type-II Quarters building no. 3 at new colony Ravi Nagar, Nagpur	105.04	११८०/-	१ महिना
6	Repairs and renovation to Type-II Quarters building no. 4 at new colony Ravi Nagar, Nagpur	105.04	११८०/-	२ महिना
7	Providing & Applying Colouring, Painting in All Main Bunglow, G.S. Bunglow, ADC Bunglow & Premises of All Servent Quters at Lok Bhavan,Nagpur.	126.05	११८०/-	१ महिना
8	Repairs to all Sewage and plumbing ducts of building No.1,2,3, &4 at MLA Hostel, civil line Nagpur.	50.42	११८०/-	१ महिना

1. Detailed tender notice can be seen on website https://mahatenders.gov.in https://mahapwd.gov.in
2. The terms and conditions of the tender shall be as indicated in the tender document.
3. If there are any changes in this tender notice, corrigendum's will be published on the above website.
4. The competent authorities reserve the right to reject or modify the tender in whole or in part without assigning any reason whatsoever.
5. The bidder shall submit the hard copy of tender document (Technical and financial Envelope) in sealed envelope within 3 days from last date of submission at the office of tender opening authority.
6. Post Qualification Criteria will be applicable for the said construction work.

O.W. No. 8805 **dt.** 30.09.2026

Dgipr/2026-27/3125

Executive Engineer
P. W. Dn. No.1 Nagpur

ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited, 1st Floor, Geet Prabha Building, Near Nirmal Hospital Cross Road, Opp. Civil Hospital, Ring Road, Surat- 395002.

PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
[See proviso to Rule 8(6)]
Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)

E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price / Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	Badai Makhan Singh (Borrower)/ Preeti Rekha (Co-Borrower) Loan A/c No. TBSIL00006889782	Plot No. 62, Row House No. 62, Ground Floor, Bhanu Nagarold Survey No. 350/5/ Paiki 1, New Survey No- Na 4340, City Survey No-Na 4340/62 Moje-Fansa, Umargam Gujarat Valsad- 396170, (Admeasuring An Area of Admesuring Land Area-108.87 Sq Mtrs, Constructed Built-Up Ground Area- 60.40 Sq Mtrs)	Rs. 14,24,403/- As on 03-10-2026	Rs. 17,20,000/- / Rs. 1,72,000/-	October 30, 2026 From 11:00 PM To 12:00 Noon	November 13, 2026 From 11:00 AM Onwards

The online auction will take place on the website (URL Link-https://BidDeal.in) of e-auction agency ValueTrust Capital Services Private Limited. The Mortgagors/ noticee are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest till November 12,2026 before 04:00 PM failing which, this secured asset will be sold as per schedule.
The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, 1st Floor, Geet Prabha Building, Near Nirmal Hospital Cross Road, Opp. Civil Hospital, Ring Road, Surat-395002 Branch on or before November 12, 2026 by 04:30 PM and thereafter they need to submit their offer through the above mentioned website only on or before November 12, 2026 by 05:00 PM along with scan image of Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. Kindly note, in case prospective bidder(s) are unable to submit their offer through the website then signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, 1st Floor, Geet Prabha Building, Near Nirmal Hospital Cross Road, Opp. Civil Hospital, Ring Road, Surat- 395002 Branch on or before November 12,2026 by 05:00 PM. Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/ Scheduled Bank in favour of "ICICI Bank Limited" payable at Surat.
For any further clarifications with regards to inspection, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of tenders, kindly contact ICICI Bank Limited on 7977863039.
The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p4s

Date: October 07, 2026
Place: Dehli

Authorized Officer
ICICI Bank Limited

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-AUCTION NOTICE

No: C-12/San/SWM/2026 **Dated : 05.10.2026**

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS **(http://ireps.gov.in/)** for Solid Waste Management at following 27 Nominated Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
SWM-DLIDIV-26-1	Dated 21.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs	SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT AT RAILWAY STATIONS OVER DELHI DIVISION-CONTRACT FOR COLLECTION, TRANSPORTATION, RECYCLING AND SCIENTIFIC PROCESSING OF SEGREGATED WET, DRY RECYCLABLE, SANITARY, SPECIAL-CARE AND INERT WASTE AT 27 DESIGNATED BULK WASTE GENERATOR (BWG) RAILWAY STATIONS OVER DELHI DIVISION NAMELY NEW DELHI, DELHI, HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN, ANAND VIHAR, DELHI SARAI ROHILLA, GHAZIABAD, MEERUT CITY, MUZAFFARNAGAR, DELHI CANTT, PANIPAT, SONIPAT, ROHTAK, GURGAON, FARIDABAD, KARNAL, KURUKSHETRA, SAHIBABAD, BAHADURGARH, PALWAL, SHAKURBASTI, SUBZI MANDI, GANAUR, NARELA, BALLABHGARH, DELHI SADAR BAZAR, BADLI & FARIDABAD NEW TOWN OVER DELHI DIVISION FOR A PERIOD OF 05 YEARS, IN ACCORDANCE WITH SOP FOR SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT RULES, 2026 ISSUED BY RAILWAY BOARD. Total 27 Railway Stations of Delhi Division
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen		**https://ireps.gov.in/**

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:
• Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module - Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module • Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. • Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email:**sanitationcell@gmail.com** Tel: 011- 23743084

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS
Northern Railway, Delhi Division

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE **3448/26**

Artic Open: Sindhu advances

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Vantyaa, October 6

Two-time Olympic medallist PV Sindhu progressed to the women's singles second round, while Tharun Mannepalli and Rounak Chouhan advanced to the men's singles main draw with wins on a mixed day for India at the USD 500,000 Arctic Open Super 500 tournament here on Tuesday.

Former world champion Sindhu, who missed out on a medal at Asian Games after losing in the quarterfinals, beat Canada's Wen Yu Zhang 21-8, 21-11 in 28 minutes.

The 31-year-old, will either face Chinese Taipei's Lin Hsiang Ti or Riko Gunji of Japan next. However, Unnati Hooda and Ashmita Chaliha fought hard before being ousted from the tournament.

Hooda, who also reached the quarters at Asiad, lost 16-21, 21-15, 22-24 to China's Han Qian Xi, while Chaliha suffered a 7-21, 21-14, 24-26 loss to seventh seed Line Christophersen of Denmark.

Malvika Bansod, meanwhile, defeated Taiwan's Sung Shuo Yun 21-15, 14-21, 21-14 to enter the main draw but couldn't get past veteran Scottish player Kirsty Gilmour, going down 18-21 13-21 in 40 minutes in the round of 32.

INDIA THRASH WI BY EIGHT WICKETS

Iyer hits maiden T20I ton, Dhir takes three on debut

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Lucknow, October 6

Skipper Shreyas Iyer led from the front with a maiden T20I century after all-rounder Naman Dhir made a dream debut with three wickets as India comfortably defeated West Indies by eight wickets in the first match here on Tuesday.

Dhir picked up three wickets with his off-spin to finish with impressive figures of 3/31, while Kuldeep Yadav took 2/33 as India, after opting to bowl, restricted West Indies to 171. Iyer (102 not out) and Ishan Kishan (37 not out) then made short work of the chase, stitching together an unbeaten 137-run partnership for the third wicket to help India chase down the target in 14.4 overs.

Chasing the total, India didn't have the best of starts as they lost both openers Abhishek Sharma (21) and Sanju Samson (11) inside four overs with the scoreboard reading 35.

Roston Chase picked up Abhishek in the third over, with Shimron Hetmyer taking a brilliant diving catch while running in from long-off. An over later, Sanju Samson departed, extending his lean patch since the Asian Games, as he sliced a short delivery back to Akeal Hosein, who took the catch off his own bowling. Thereafter, skipper Shreyas Iyer and Ishan Kishan stabilised the innings with a 137-run partnership.



India's captain Shreyas Iyer celebrates his century with Ishan Kishan during the first T20I match against West Indies, in Lucknow PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- Chasing the total, India didn't have the best of starts as they lost both openers Abhishek Sharma (21) and Sanju Samson (11) inside four overs with the scoreboard reading 35
- The four boundaries forced skipper Shreyas Iyer to replace Mayank with Axar Patel in third over

Iyer, in particular, looked ominous, smashing boundaries all around the ground and taking the initiative to guide the chase.

With his captain in great touch, Ishan played second fiddle as India remained in command, reaching 102 for two at the halfway mark.

Iyer was elegant with his strokeplay, finding the boundaries with classical shots, including a straight six over long-off off pacer Shamar Springer in the 11th over.

The Mumbaikar remained in ominous touch and made the chase a cakewalk, smashing Hosein over long-off for a maximum before hitting the left-arm spinner through the same region for a boundary off the next ball. Iyer then went hammer and tongs, finding fours and sixes at will to bring up his century off 42 balls with a straight six over long-on off Chase.

Earlier, sent into bat, West Indies skipper Shai Hope started the innings in a flurry, smacking Mayank Yadav for four boundaries in the second over to set the tone. The four boundaries forced skipper Shreyas Iyer to replace Mayank with Axar Patel in third over.

Arshdeep got the first breakthrough for India, cleaning up Kamil Pooran with a pitch-up delivery.

West Indies were dealt another blow in the sixth over when Shimron Hetmyer was run out while going for an unnecessary single. It turned out to be double blow for the West Indies as Axar cleaned up Rovman Powell in the sixth over with a pitch-up delivery after the right-hander went for a huge heave over square-leg.

I've done my duty: Harmanpreet

She steps down from India women's team captaincy

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 6

India's only World Cup-winning women's cricket captain Harmanpreet Kaur on Tuesday stepped down from her position in all three formats, saying that she has done her duty as leader and is now "ready to play for the love of the game again."

The 37-year-old's announcement came after a BCCI review meeting in Guwahati to evaluate the team's trajectory in the past few months. Chaired by BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia, the meeting was attended by Harmanpreet, vice-captain Smriti Mandhana and head coach Amol Muzumdar.

Mandhana, who has recently been vocal about her ambitions to lead the 'Women in Blue', is the front-runner to take over as the next captain and a formal announcement of her elevation is expected soon.

"Today, I step down as captain of the Indian Women's Cricket Team across all formats," Harmanpreet, who has been enduring a lean patch for a while now, wrote in an Instagram post.

"This is not an easy decision. It carries years of memories, emotions, sacrifices, and moments that will stay with me for the rest of my life," added the right-hander, who had earlier spoken about wanting to lead the team till at least the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics for which India have already qualified.



Women's cricket captain Harmanpreet Kaur

India, 6 other countries want to host 2036 Olympics

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Lausanne, October 6

The International Olympic Committee on Tuesday said India, Germany, Qatar and Turkiye are among seven countries with a stated interest in hosting the 2036 Olympics and have been invited to present their Games projects to the IOC's Future Host Commission next month.

The IOC said the projects will be assessed on a number of technical factors such as venue master-plan and athlete experience, funding strategy, political and public support, Games delivery capabilities, and legacy strategy to create long-term benefits for host communities.

"The Interested Parties currently in Continuous Dialogue with the IOC, with a stated interest in hosting the 2036 Olympic Games, are (in alphabetical order): Germany, Hungary, India, Qatar, Republic of Korea, South Africa and Turkiye," read a statement from the IOC.

'MEN JUST NEED TO GET OUT OF THE WAY'

Vijay said he is 'sick' of being called a 'red flag' after playing grey characters on-screen



Vijay Varma opened up about his recurring 'red flag' image on screen, saying he is tired of being categorised by the label and would like to explore characters that bring something different to his filmography.

The actor, who has portrayed several morally complex and grey-shaded characters in projects including 'Darlings', 'Dahaad' and 'Pink', was recently introduced as the 'biggest red flag on screen' at an event hosted by content creator Dolly Singh. Speaking to 'HT City', Varma reacted to the tag, discussed his latest role in 'Lust Stories 3' and shared his views on women's safety.

HE ADDRESSED THE LARGER CONVERSATION AROUND WOMEN'S SAFETY AMID CONCERNS OVER CRIMES AGAINST WOMEN

At a recent event, Dolly Singh introduced Vijay Varma as the 'biggest red flag on screen', referencing the actor's track record of playing complicated or morally questionable characters. A video from the event subsequently circulated on social media, with some viewers observing that Varma appeared uncomfortable with the introduction.

Addressing the constant categorisation of his screen characters, the actor told 'HT City', "I just want a different colour, man. I'm sick of this red flag, green flag."

Varma also explained why his role in 'Lust Stories 3' felt different from several of the characters he has played previously. Unlike some of his more intense roles, his character in the anthology is someone who fails to pick up on the obvious signals around him. Varma said that quality made the role particularly enjoyable because it allowed him to play a character who was not constantly reading the situation correctly.

"I like the guy because he just doesn't get any hint," he said. AGENCIES





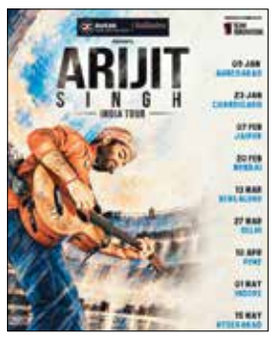
Arijit announces nine-city India tour in 2027

The tour will celebrate 20 years of music that includes Singh's hit chartbusters

NEW DELHI: Popular playback artist Arijit Singh announced a nine-city, stadium-scale India tour for 2027 to celebrate 20 years of music that includes chartbusters 'Agar Tum Saath Ho', 'Tum Hi Ho', 'Vida Karo' and many more.

Singh, who shocked millions of his fans in January this year by announcing that he was retiring from a playback career to focus on solo artistic pursuits, is embarking on his biggest-ever India tour, starting from January 2027 to May 2027.

"20 years of music is a journey I feel very grateful for. The greatest part of it has always been the people - the listeners who have given these songs a life of their own. I'm really looking forward to travelling across India and experiencing that love together, live on stage. There are so many songs, so many memories and so many people to meet. I can't wait," Singh said.



"20 YEARS OF MUSIC IS A JOURNEY I FEEL VERY GRATEFUL FOR"

Produced and promoted by 'Team Innovation' and ticketed exclusively on 'thumpN', the tour will entail multiple stadium presentations and will travel to Ahmedabad, Chandigarh, Jaipur, Mumbai, Bengaluru, New Delhi, Pune, Indore and Hyderabad. PTI

Prime Video debuts first look images of 'Bloodaxe'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
California, October 6

Prime Video' revealed first-look images of the highly anticipated new series, 'Bloodaxe'. The series comes from showrunners Michael Hirst (creator of 'Vikings') and Horatio Hirst. 'Bloodaxe' has been picked up for a second season, which is currently in production in Ireland.

In season one, 'Bloodaxe' chronicles the rise of one of history's most famous Norse raiders, Erik Bloodaxe (Xavier Molyneux) and his formidable wife Gunnhild, Mother of Kings (Jessica Madsen). As they fight for the throne of Norway, the land is torn apart by fierce rivals, shifting loyalties and bloody betrayals. With war looming and chaos consuming the kingdom, drawing in the ruthless Kings of other Scandinavian countries and even a powerful English ruler, the stage is set for a thundering, cataclysmic, compelling and utterly magical new Norse Saga.

The first season stars Xavier Molyneux, Jessica Madsen, Karlis Arnolds Avots, Levi Miller, Rod Hallett, Alina Tomnikov, Sisse Marie, Rune Temte and Jesper Christensen.

'Bloodaxe' is executive produced by Michael and Horatio Hirst, who also show-run and write. Additional executive producers include Morgan O'Sullivan under his 'O'Sullivan Productions' label, Steve Stark under his 'Toluca Pictures' label, Arturo Interian, John Weber and Sheila Hockin.

